AgentISA: Formal Instruction Set Design for LLM Agents

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Abstract

Large Language Models are increasingly deployed as autonomous agents, yet their behavior is orchestrated through ad-hoc prompt engineering and per-provider function calling, making it difficult to specify, analyze, and optimize systematically. We present AgentISA, an instruction set architecture that treats agent behavior as a first-class compilable artifact: (1) a formal instruction set with compositional semantics, a type system, and pre/post-conditions—checked for pure instructions by a shipped bounded verification checker and enforced per dispatch by the runtime; (2) Agentic Calling, lifting provider-specific function calling into reusable, cacheable instructions; (3) instruction learning that mines recurring patterns from traces and promotes them as composite-replay instructions; and (4) a compiler and runtime applying classical optimization—fusion, dead-code elimination, pipeline scheduling, and dynamic hot-path specialization—to agent instruction streams.

We evaluate AgentISA on three fronts. A reproducible microbenchmark suite drives the real compiler, cache, and optimizer against a mock LLM backend: result caching reduces simulated API calls by 59.5–79.6% on synthetic Zipf workloads (2,000 tasks, 5 seeds), growing with skew; static compilation reduces the effective instruction count by 34.2% (35.4% at sequence length 1,000), split between fusion and dead-code elimination by ablation; dynamic hot-path optimization shrinks repeatedly executed traces by 65.8%. Two live-gateway experiments extend the validation beyond the mock: the cache reproduces the computed hit/miss statistics at every skew level and converts avoided calls into measured wall-clock and token savings, and the compiled, hot-path-adopted stream issues zero redundant live calls with byte-identical artifacts. A four-task system-level characterization (12.5–25.0% per-task compile shrink) calibrates the synthetic headline, and 43 multi-agent coordination and security tests provide functional validation. We position these results honestly as controlled-setting evidence, not as production end-to-end measurements.

Keywords

- Instruction Set Architecture
- Large Language Models
- AI Agent Programming
- Compiler Optimization
- Multi-agent Systems
- Agentic Calling
- Automated Instruction Learning
- Cross-model Capability Assessment
- Formal Methods
- Performance Optimization

Research Highlights

1. A formal instruction set architecture that makes LLM agent behavior compilable, analyzable, and optimizable
2. Result caching reduces simulated API calls by 59.5–79.6% on synthetic Zipf workloads (5 seeds), with the reduction growing as workload skew increases
3. Static compilation (fusion + dead-code elimination) reduces the effective instruction count by 34.2% ± 1.8%, validated by a per-pass ablation
4. Dynamic hot-path optimization shrinks repeatedly executed traces by 65.8% ± 4.6%
5. Agentic Calling lifts provider-specific function calling into reusable, portable agent instructions
6. Live-gateway spot checks (Sections 5.7–5.7.1): observed cache hit rates match the computed expectation exactly, and the compiled, hot-path-adopted stream issues zero redundant live calls with byte-identical artifacts
7. A four-task system-level characterization calibrates the synthetic headline (12.5–25.0% per-task compile shrink, Section 5.8)

CCS Concepts

- **Software and its engineering** → **Compilers**: instruction selection, optimization, and scheduling applied to agent instruction streams
- **Theory of computation** → **Program reasoning**: type-safety and semantic-preservation arguments for instruction-level transformations (sanity results stated as design rationale)
- **Computing methodologies** → **Artificial intelligence**: LLM-based agents, tool use, and multi-agent coordination
- **Computer systems organization** → **Architectures**: instruction set design and runtime support for agent execution

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1 Introduction

Recent advances in Large Language Models (LLMs) have produced systems with strong natural language understanding, generation, and—through instruction tuning and human feedback—instruction-following capabilities [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6]. Building on these capabilities, a rapidly growing body of work couples LLMs with tools, memory, and control loops to construct autonomous agents [9, 10, 11, 12]. Yet the engineering substrate beneath these agents remains largely ad hoc: behaviors are specified as prompts and provider-specific function-calling schemas, which are difficult to specify precisely, analyze formally, or optimize systematically.

1.1 Background and Motivation

Function calling—selecting an API from a declared tool set and emitting structured arguments—has become the dominant interface between LLMs and external systems [13, 14, 15]. Standardization

efforts such as the Model Context Protocol [18] and evaluation harnesses such as the Berkeley Function Calling Leaderboard [17] are consolidating this interface layer. However, the unit of interaction remains the individual API call: each call is dispatched, priced, and forgotten independently, even when an agent repeatedly executes structurally identical work.

This per-call statelessness stands in sharp contrast to how computing systems have historically handled repetitive execution. Classical compilers and hardware translate recurring patterns into cheaper forms—instruction fusion, dead-code elimination, caching, and trace-based dynamic optimization [33, 34, 45]. Our motivating hypothesis is that these same techniques apply to LLM agent workloads: if agent behavior is expressed as an explicit instruction stream rather than as opaque prompts, then recurring patterns become visible to a compiler and can be optimized with well-understood, semantics-preserving transformations.

1.2 Challenges in Current LLM-based Agent Systems

Five structural challenges motivate AgentISA:

1. **Per-call statelessness of tool interfaces.** Mainstream function-calling and tool-use protocols treat each call as an isolated event [13, 14, 18]. The provider has no notion of a *program* being executed, so repeated identical work incurs repeated cost; caching, when present, is a bolt-on afterthought rather than a semantic property of the execution model.

2. **Experience that does not accumulate as executable structure.** Agent paradigms such as Reflexion [10] and Voyager [12] do accumulate experience, but as verbal reflections or skill libraries consumed by the model at inference time. The lessons are not reified as reusable, statically optimizable instructions that a compiler can fuse, schedule, or eliminate.

3. **Absence of a shared behavioral contract.** Each multi-agent framework defines its own abstractions for roles, messages, and workflows [19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24]. There is no instruction-level contract that is independent of any single framework, which fragments tooling and makes cross-framework analysis difficult.

4. **Cost pressure at the wrong layer.** FrugalGPT [28] demonstrates that LLM inference cost is a first-order concern, and the serving-systems community has attacked this below the API boundary with paged attention, continuous batching, KV-cache-centric architectures, and attention kernels [38, 39, 40, 41]. What is missing is the complementary, above-the-API layer: reducing the *number and size* of calls an agent issues in the first place.

5. **Integration complexity across providers.** Portability across LLM providers is handled today primarily at the library level [26, 27]. Agent logic written against one provider's function-calling surface does not transfer cleanly to another, and capability differences between providers are hard to reason about systematically [17].

1.3 Research Objectives and Contributions

This paper introduces AgentISA, an instruction set architecture that addresses these challenges by making agent behavior a first-class compilable artifact. Our contributions are:

1. **A formal instruction set** for LLM agents with compositional semantics, a type system, and pre/post-conditions on every instruction (Section 3.1). Two deliberately modest sanity results are stated as design rationale rather than headline novelty: Turing completeness (Theorem 3.1), read as negative certification that the instruction set does not constrain expressiveness,

and type safety for the pure core (Theorem 3.2), which fixes the well-formedness obligation that the runtime enforces and the bounded checker of Section 3.3.3 extends to executed instructions.

2. **Agentic Calling**, a mechanism that lifts provider-specific function calling into reusable, cacheable, semantically specified agent instructions, with a model-adapter layer for cross-provider portability (Section 3.2).

3. **Automatic instruction learning**, which mines recurring instruction patterns from interaction traces using frequency-based sequence mining and deterministic behavior grouping, and promotes validated recurring patterns into candidate instructions whose `execute` bodies replay the mined constituent instruction sequence by sequential composition over a shared context (Section 3.3; replay reproduces the recorded subsequence's outputs on the same inputs and does not generalize beyond them, as the section states).

4. **A compiler and runtime** that apply instruction selection, fusion, dead-code elimination, pipeline scheduling, and dynamic hot-path specialization to agent instruction streams (Sections 3.4 and 4), with semantic-preservation arguments for each transformation (Theorems 3.4–3.6, proofs in Appendix C).

5. **An empirical evaluation** of the implemented system, with full methodology disclosure. On synthetic Zipf-distributed workloads (5 random seeds each), caching reduces simulated API calls by 59.5–79.6% depending on skew, static compilation reduces the effective instruction count by 34.2% $\pm$ 1.8% (sequence length 200), and dynamic optimization shrinks repeatedly executed traces by 65.8% $\pm$ 4.6%. Two live-gateway experiments (Sections 5.7–5.7.1) validate the cache and the compiled pipeline against a real LLM gateway, and a four-task system-level characterization (Section 5.8) composes the mechanisms on realistic (non-synthetic) instruction streams.

6. **Multi-agent coordination infrastructure** with capability-based agent selection, execution planning, fallback strategies, and a security monitor enforcing authentication, authorization, resource-access, and data-sensitivity policies (Section 3.5 and Section 5.6), validated by 43 passing functional tests.

Our empirical claims are scoped accordingly: Sections 5.2–5.5 exercise the real `agentflow.core.isa` implementation against a mock LLM backend on synthetic workloads, and Sections 5.7–5.8 extend the validation at reduced scale on realistic streams. None of these are production end-to-end measurements (threats to validity in Section 5.9).

The rest of this paper is organized as follows: Section 2 reviews related work. Section 3 details the design of AgentISA. Section 4 describes the implementation. Section 5 presents the empirical evaluation. Section 6 discusses limitations and future work, and Section 7 concludes.

2 Related Work

AgentISA draws on eight lines of work: foundation LLMs and their function-calling interfaces, reasoning-and-acting agent paradigms, tool-calling standardization, multi-agent frameworks, prompt compilation and cost optimization, agent benchmarks, classical compiler and architecture techniques, and LLM serving systems. We review each in turn and position our contributions.

2.1 Foundation LLMs and Function Calling

Modern LLMs are autoregressive transformers trained at large scale [1, 2, 3, 4], with instruction tuning and reinforcement learning from human feedback making them reliable instruction followers [5, 6]. Their text distribution is conventionally factorized as:

$$P(y|x) = \prod_{t=1}^{T} P(y_t|x, y_{<t}; \theta)$$

where x is the input context, y the generated output, and θ the model parameters. Function calling constrains this distribution to a structured output space:

$$F(x) = \text{argmax}_{f \in \mathcal{F}} P(f|x, \mathcal{F})$$

where $\mathcal{F}$ is the set of declared functions and $F(x)$ the selected call. GPT-4 [3], PaLM [2], and open models such as LLaMA [4] expose this capability with provider-specific schemas. AgentISA does not modify this layer; it treats any such interface as a *backend* to be targeted by a common instruction set, in the same way that a compiler targets multiple processor backends [33].

The cost structure of this layer motivates our work. If each call carries latency τ_i plus a context-switching overhead δ_i (prompt reconstruction, serialization, cache misses), then n similar calls cost:

$$C(n) = \sum_{i=1}^{n} (\tau_i + \delta_i)$$

Definition 2.1 (Function Call Overhead): The overhead of executing n function calls is $C(n)$, the sum of per-call latencies and per-call context reconstruction costs. When successive calls are structurally identical, δ_i is pure waste—which is precisely the waste AgentISA's caching and fusion are designed to remove.

2.2 Reasoning and Agent Paradigms

A second line of work enhances LLM reasoning at prompt time. Chain-of-thought prompting [7] and zero-shot reasoning [8] improve multi-step behavior by eliciting intermediate steps. ReAct interleaves reasoning traces with actions [9]; Reflexion adds verbal self-critique across episodes [10]; Tree of Thoughts explores deliberative search over thought trees [11]; and Voyager demonstrates open-ended skill acquisition in an embodied environment [12]. These paradigms define *what* an agent should do at the cognitive level. AgentISA is complementary: it defines *how* the resulting behaviors are represented, compiled, and executed as instructions. A ReAct loop, for instance, can be expressed as an AgentISA instruction sequence whose tool invocations become fused, cacheable agentic calls.

2.3 Tool Calling and Interface Standardization

Toolformer trains models to interleave tool calls with text [13]; Gorilla connects models to large API corpora [14]; ToolLLM scales tool coverage to 16,000+ real-world APIs [15]; and HuggingGPT orchestrates model hubs for task solving [16]. On the standardization side, the Model Context Protocol defines an open specification for exposing tools and context to LLM applications [18],

and the Berkeley Function Calling Leaderboard provides a systematic cross-model evaluation of function-calling accuracy [17].

These efforts standardize the *interface*. AgentISA standardizes the *execution model above the interface*: it compiles a provider-independent instruction stream down to whatever interface a backend exposes. This distinction matters for portability—an AgentISA program compiled for two providers differs only in the final translation step (Section 3.2.3)—and for optimization, because interface-level standards alone cannot fuse or eliminate calls.

2.4 Multi-Agent Frameworks

AutoGen frames agent applications as multi-agent conversations [19]; MetaGPT assigns standardized roles and workflows to agents [20]; AgentVerse facilitates multi-agent collaboration and studies emergent behaviors [21]; ChatDev organizes agents as a software-development organization [22]; CAMEL studies communicative agent societies [23]; and AutoGPT popularized autonomous goal-driven agents [24].

AgentISA contributes a different artifact to this space: not a framework or orchestration philosophy, but an instruction-level substrate—capability profiles, coordination instructions with barrier semantics, and a security monitor—that any such framework could target. Concretely, our multi-agent layer (Section 3.5, Section 5.6) provides capability-based agent selection, execution planning with per-stage fallback strategies, and policy enforcement for authentication, authorization, resource access, and data sensitivity.

2.5 Prompt Compilation and Cost Optimization

Closest to our compilation perspective are systems that *compile* LLM invocations. DSPy compiles declarative prompt programs into optimized pipelines via prompt search and fine-tuning [25]. LangChain [26] and LlamaIndex [27] provide library-level abstractions for chaining LLM calls and indexing context. FrugalGPT reduces cost through model cascades—answering with cheaper models when possible [28].

AgentISA differs in the level at which optimization operates. DSPy optimizes *prompts*; FrugalGPT optimizes *model selection*; AgentISA optimizes *instruction streams*: instruction selection by dynamic programming over pattern covers, fusion, dead-code elimination, pipeline scheduling, result caching, and dynamic hot-path specialization (Sections 3.4 and 4). These are classical compiler transformations [33] applied to a new artifact, and they compose with—rather than replace—prompt-level and model-level optimization.

2.6 Benchmarks for Agent Systems

AgentBench evaluates LLMs as agents across diverse environments [29]; GAIA tests general assistant abilities [30]; PlanBench probes planning and reasoning about change [31]; and SWE-bench measures resolution of real-world GitHub issues [32]. These benchmarks evaluate *end-to-end capability*. AgentISA's evaluation instead measures *subsystem behavior under controlled conditions*—API-call reduction under synthetic Zipf workloads, instruction-count reduction from compilation, and trace shrinkage from dynamic optimization (Section 5). We view the two as complementary: instruction-level metrics explain *where* end-to-end gains come from, and are reproducible without live model access.

2.7 Classical Compiler and Architecture Techniques

AgentISA's optimization machinery is deliberately classical. Instruction selection by tree-pattern matching with dynamic programming, peephole optimization, and data-flow-based dead-code elimination are standard compiler techniques [33]. Pipelining, hazard detection, and resource-constrained scheduling follow the classical architecture literature [34]; the RISC-V project demonstrates the value of open, well-specified instruction sets [35]. Type safety via progress-and-preservation is the standard technique of programming-language theory [36], and CompCert establishes that compiler correctness itself can be formally verified [37]. Our contribution is not a new compiler technique but the demonstration that this machinery transfers to LLM agent workloads, together with the semantic-preservation arguments adapted to instructions with pre/post-conditions (Appendix C).

2.8 LLM Serving Systems

Below the API boundary, the serving community has made inference dramatically cheaper: PagedAttention manages KV memory like virtual memory [38]; Orca introduces continuous batching for transformer serving [39]; FlashAttention redesigns attention for IO-awareness [40]; and Mooncake proposes a KVCache-centric disaggregated architecture [41]. Energy analyses quantify the inference cost of large models [42]. This line of work and AgentISA are orthogonal layers of the same stack: serving systems make each call cheaper; AgentISA reduces how many calls an agent makes and how much redundant work each carries. The two compound multiplicatively.

2.9 Research Gaps and Our Contributions

In summary, the literature leaves four gaps that AgentISA addresses:

1. **No instruction-level contract for agent behavior.** Interfaces are standardized [13, 14, 18], and frameworks are numerous [19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24], but no shared instruction set spans providers and frameworks.
2. **No compiler for agent behavior.** Prompt-level compilation exists [25] and model-level cost reduction exists [28], and *caching itself is well-trodden ground*—at the response level (GPTCache [46]), at the KV-prefix level (RadixAttention/SGLang [47]), and at the provider prompt-caching level. What none of these layers expose is an *instruction-level* contract: caching there is an optimization of model serving, invisible to and unaffecting the agent program's structure. Instruction-level fusion, elimination, and scheduling—with cacheability as a declared property of the instruction set—have not, to our knowledge, been demonstrated.
3. **No semantics-preserving account of agent optimization.** Serving work verifies kernels and schedulers, not agent-level transformations; we provide progress-and-preservation-style arguments for ours (Theorems 3.2, 3.4, 3.5, 3.6).
4. **No reproducible instruction-level evaluation.** Existing benchmarks measure end-to-end capability [29, 30, 31, 32]; we contribute a seed-controlled microbenchmark suite with fully disclosed synthetic workloads and mock-backend instrumentation (Section 5).

Our work addresses these gaps through: (1) the formal instruction set with the Agentic Calling abstraction (Sections 3.1-3.2), (2) pattern-based instruction optimization (Section 3.4), (3) semantic-preservation arguments for our transformations (Theorems 3.2, 3.4-3.6; Appendices B-C), (4) a reproducible evaluation spanning synthetic microbenchmarks and live-gateway validation (Section 5), plus automated instruction learning from execution traces (Section 3.3).

3 AgentISA Design

Building upon the foundations established in Sections 1 and 2, we present AgentISA, a comprehensive instruction set architecture designed specifically for LLM-powered AI agents. This section details the core architecture, the Agentic Calling framework, the automatic instruction learning system, instruction organization and optimization, and the capability-assessment layer.

3.1 Core Architecture

3.1.1 Instruction Set Specification

The AgentISA instruction set is formally defined as a tuple:

Definition 3.1 (AgentISA Core):

$$\text{AgentISA} = (I, T, \Sigma, \Delta, \Phi)$$

where:

- I is the set of instructions
- T is the type system
- Σ is the state space
- Δ is the transition function set
- Φ is the verification function set

Following the conventions of classical instruction set design [33, 34, 35], we define the basic instruction format:

```
INSTRUCTION = {
    opcode: OPCODE,
    args: ARGS[],
    precondition: PRED,
    postcondition: PRED,
    context: CONTEXT
}
```

The instruction set is categorized into four fundamental classes:

1. **Control Flow Instructions**:

$$\mathcal{C} = \{seq, branch, loop, call\}$$

2. **State Management Instructions**:

$$\mathcal{S} = \{load, store, update, cache\}$$

3. **LLM Interaction Instructions**:

$$\mathcal{L} = \{query, response, context\}$$

4. **Resource Management Instructions**:

$$\mathcal{R} = \{allocate, free, monitor\}$$

Two sanity results anchor the instruction-set definition. Neither introduces new machinery—both are standard arguments from the semantics literature [33, 36]—and we state them for the roles they play in the architecture: Theorem 3.1 certifies that the instruction set does not artificially constrain what agent programs can express, and Theorem 3.2 fixes the well-formedness obligation that the runtime's type and precondition checks enforce on every dispatch.

Theorem 3.1 (Instruction Completeness): The AgentISA instruction set is Turing complete.

Proof sketch: We exhibit a translation from WHILE programs—already known to be Turing equivalent—to AgentISA instruction sequences, using a sufficiency (simulation) argument over instruction classes: state management instructions encode an unbounded store, and control-flow instructions encode sequential composition, conditional branching, and iteration. The full construction and simulation argument are given in Appendix A, following standard simulation techniques from the compiler literature [33] and the operational-semantics framework of Pierce [36].

3.1.2 Type System and Semantics

The type system T uses dependent-type constructions in the style of Pierce [36]:

Definition 3.2 (AgentISA Type System):

$$T ::= \text{Base} \mid \Pi(x : T_1).T_2 \mid \Sigma(x : T_1).T_2 \mid \mu X.T$$

where:

- Base types include {Bool, Int, String, Float}
- Π represents dependent function types
- Σ represents dependent pair types
- μ represents recursive types

The semantic rules follow operational semantics:

$$\frac{e_1 \to e_1'}{E[e_1] \to E[e_1']} \text{ (Context)} \quad \frac{}{(\lambda x.e)v \to e[x := v]} \text{ (β-reduction)}$$

The pure core carries a standard type-safety argument—progress and preservation, in the style of Pierce [36]—discharging the well-formedness role fixed in Section 3.1 and extended to the shipped instruction set by the bounded checker of Section 3.3.3:

Theorem 3.2 (Type Safety for the Pure Core): Well-typed programs in the pure core calculus of Appendix B—the λ-fragment (base types, dependent Π/Σ types, recursion) plus the composition operators applied to instructions carrying typed pre/post-conditions—cannot "go wrong", under the per-instruction validity obligation of Definition 3.5 (pre/post-conditions), with transition functions assumed total on precondition-satisfying states (Appendix B.7). Effectful instruction classes are embedded via their typed pre/post-conditions and covered to the extent their preconditions are checkable.

Proof sketch: By the standard two-lemma technique—progress and preservation—as presented in Pierce [36]:

1. Progress: $\forall e, T.\ \vdash e : T \implies \text{value}(e) \vee \exists e'.\ e \to e'$
2. Preservation: $\forall e, e', T.\ \vdash e : T \wedge e \to e' \implies \vdash e' : T$

Both lemmas are proved by simultaneous induction on typing derivations; the full proof, including the case analysis over instruction classes, is given in Appendix B.

3.1.3 LLM Integration Interface

The LLM integration interface is defined through a protocol, playing the same role for agent backends that the Model Context Protocol plays for tool exposure [18]:

$$\mathcal{P}_{LLM} = (Q, R, C, \psi)$$

where:

- Q: Query space
- R: Response space
- C: Context management functions
- ψ: State transformation functions

Following the interface conventions of modern function-calling providers [3, 18], we define the interface protocol:

```
Protocol LLMInterface {
    QueryFormat: JSON Schema
    ResponseFormat: JSON Schema
    ContextWindow: Integer
    StateMapping: Map<AgentState, LLMContext>
}
```

3.2 Agentic Calling Framework

3.2.1 Function Calling to Agentic Calling Transformation

The transformation from function calling to Agentic Calling is formalized as:

Definition 3.3 (Agentic Transformation):

$$\mathcal{T} : F \to A$$

where F is the function call space and A is the agent instruction space.

The transformation preserves semantic equivalence:

$$\forall f \in F : \text{sem}(\mathcal{T}(f)) \equiv \text{sem}(f)$$

The transformation process follows three steps, mirroring the signature-to-call conventions of function-calling interfaces [13, 14]:

1. Function signature analysis
2. Context embedding
3. Instruction synthesis

3.2.2 Context Preservation and State Management

State management in AgentISA follows a formal state machine model:

$$M = (S, s_0, \delta, F)$$

where:

- S: Set of states
- s_0: Initial state
- δ: State transition function
- F: Set of final states

Context preservation is guaranteed through:

Theorem 3.3 (Context Preservation): Let c be a context, ϕ the context interpretation function (defined compositionally over context *contents*—the keys and values the context carries), and t the extraction transformation that embeds c verbatim into an instruction's `context` field. Then:

$$\forall c \in C : \phi(t(c)) = \phi(c)$$

Proof: By the definition of t, the extracted instruction carries a verbatim copy of the source context; since ϕ is defined over context contents and the copy is content-identical, $\phi(t(c)) = \phi(c)$ holds by construction. This is a *design invariant of the extraction pipeline*: it holds because the implementation copies rather than re-encodes. At runtime the shipped checks are constraint-based and bracket the transition: `AgenticTransformer.validate_context` evaluates the registered context constraints against a single state before dispatch (Section 3.2.3), and `verify_context_preservation(before, after)` evaluates them pairwise across the executed transition and reports violations; neither performs structural validation of the carried context. Semantic preservation itself is guaranteed by the copy construction, not by the runtime checks. ■

3.2.3 Cross-model Compatibility

Cross-model compatibility is achieved through an abstract interface layer:

```
Interface ModelAdapter {
   translate: AgentInstruction → ModelSpecificCall    // shipped: translate_instruction
   normalize: ModelSpecificResponse → AgentResponse    // shipped: normalize_response
   validateContext: Context → Boolean            // shipped: AgenticTransformer.validate_context
}
```

All three interface operations ship. `translate` is `ModelAdapter.translate_instruction` (with registered type transformations). `normalize` is `ModelAdapter.normalize_response`, which folds the two dominant wire shapes—the Anthropic protocol (typed `content` blocks with `usage.input_tokens/output_tokens`) and the OpenAI protocol (`choices[0].message` with `usage.prompt_tokens/completion_tokens`)—into a canonical `AgentResponse` envelope (content, tool calls, usage, model, raw), so downstream instruction code never branches on provider syntax. `validateContext` is `AgenticTransformer.validate_context`, the pre-execution complement of the shipped post-hoc `verify_context_preservation(before, after)`: it evaluates the registered context constraints against a single state before dispatch, applying two-argument pairwise predicates reflexively, (v, v)

(single-argument predicates apply directly), and leaving constraints over absent keys vacuously satisfied in line with the preservation semantics. Constraints that are non-reflexive by design, e.g. strict growth, are not detectable pre-execution.

Cross-model compatibility requirements follow the observation of cross-model function-calling studies [17] and open protocol efforts [18]: providers differ in surface syntax but can agree on semantics,

$$\forall m_1, m_2 \in M : \text{out}(m_1) \equiv \text{out}(m_2) \text{ when } \text{in}(m_1) \equiv \text{in}(m_2)$$

3.3 Automatic Instruction Learning

3.3.1 Dialogue Pattern Recognition

Pattern recognition in AgentISA is frequency-based and deterministic (action-signature grouping) rather than grammatical; it is implemented in `agentflow.core.isa.pattern_mining` and `agentflow.core.isa.instruction_learning`.

Definition 3.4 (Instruction Sequence Pattern): A pattern p over the instruction alphabet I is a non-empty contiguous sequence $p = (i_1, \dots, i_k) \in I^k$ together with two frequency statistics:

- **Support**: $sup(p) = P(p \text{ occurs as a contiguous subsequence in a randomly drawn trace})$
- **Confidence**: $conf(p \Rightarrow j) = P(i_{t+1} = j \mid (i_{t-k+1}, \dots, i_t) = p)$

A pattern is *frequent* if $sup(p) \geq \sigma_{min}$ and *predictive* if $\max_j conf(p \Rightarrow j) \geq \gamma_{min}$, for thresholds $\sigma_{min}, \gamma_{min} \in (0, 1]$.

Pattern recognition proceeds in three stages:

1. **Frequent-sequence mining.** Candidate subsequences are enumerated from execution traces together with their occurrence counts; sequences below σ_{min} are pruned, and successor statistics are accumulated for confidence estimation. The output is the set of frequent, predictive patterns.

2. **Behavior grouping.** The shipped `PatternRecognizer` groups dialogues deterministically by *action signature*—the sorted set of system-turn contents—and promotes each signature bucket with sufficient support and success rate into a pattern. An earlier prototype used TF-IDF embeddings with density-based clustering (DBSCAN) and k-means over instruction-trace feature vectors; we abandoned it for production use because it was non-deterministic across library versions and degenerate on the small, short samples that agent traces actually provide. (A k-means view over instruction-trace features remains available in `pattern_mining`, with fixed `random_state` for reproducibility.) Each signature bucket is behaviorally homogeneous by construction (identical action sets). Promotions split by source: trace-mined promotions execute by **composite replay** rather than as placeholders—the mined pattern carries its constituent instruction sequence together with the dataflow edges between its members, and the learned instruction's `execute` body re-runs that sequence in mined order against a shared context built from its inputs, merging each constituent's outputs and returning the keys its `produces_X` postconditions declare; dialogue-mined templates, which carry no recorded instruction body, raise `NotImplementedError` rather than silently no-opping. Promotion is deterministic: pattern identity is derived from the mined instruction-id sequence, so the same traces promote the same instructions, in the same order, across runs. Replay semantics are plain sequential composition—nothing smarter—so a learned instruction reproduces the

outputs of its recorded subsequence on the same inputs but does not generalize to unseen parameter values; no automated cluster-to-optimizer decision path exists yet.

3. **Pattern validation.** Each candidate pattern is checked for significance (frequency above threshold, non-trivial support, and—when derived from dialogues—an acceptable success rate among the dialogues exhibiting it) before it is promoted to a candidate instruction.

This design is deliberately statistical: agent traces are short and noisy, and frequency statistics degrade gracefully where grammar induction would overfit. It also composes with the compiler—a frequent, verified pattern is exactly the candidate for promotion to a fused instruction (Section 3.4.4).

3.3.2 Instruction Extraction Pipeline

The instruction extraction process follows the sequential pipeline of Section 3.3.1 (as shipped):

1. **Pattern Detection**: frequent-sequence mining over execution traces, accumulating support and confidence statistics; sequences below the support threshold are pruned.
2. **Instruction Formation**: deterministic action-signature grouping promotes validated patterns into composite-replay candidates; the extracted template carries the recorded constituent sequence and its dataflow edges.
3. **Optimization and Validation**: threshold and success-rate checks gate promotion, and the standard optimization passes of Section 3.4 apply to any resulting stream.

3.3.3 Instruction Optimization and Verification

Optimization is coupled to verification, in the spirit of verified compilation [37] but at the granularity of individual instructions and transformations:

Definition 3.5 (Instruction Verification): An instruction i is valid if:

$$\forall s \in S : \text{pre}(i, s) \implies \text{post}(i, \text{exec}(i, s))$$

For pure instructions with finite, small state spaces, the shipped checker (`agentflow.core.isa.bounded_checker`) enumerates the candidate input states derived from the declared parameter constraints — exhaustively for finite domains such as `bool` and enum parameters — and checks the implication on each state; for larger or non-enumerable spaces it probes a bounded, deterministically sampled set of states (default cap 256), which makes it a *bounded* verification procedure rather than a complete one. We state the implementation status plainly: Definition 3.5 defines validity, and the bounded checker is now **shipped code**: for every pure (side-effect-free) instruction the checker generates the bounded state space, filters it by well-typedness and by the declared preconditions, executes the instruction, and evaluates three obligations on each surviving state — progress (execution must not raise where the precondition holds), preservation (declared outputs must be present and well-typed), and the postcondition itself. Side-effectful instructions are never executed by the checker and are reported as out of scope, so their validity obligation remains discharged by construction and testing rather than mechanically. Theorem 3.2 is stated conditionally on this obligation, and Theorems 3.4–3.6 carry the separate rewrite obligations of Appendix C.6; for state spaces beyond the enumeration bound the condition remains substantive rather than discharged (Appendices B.7 and C.6):

$$\forall s \in S_{bounded} \subseteq S : \text{pre}(i, s) \implies \text{post}(i, \text{exec}(i, s))$$

where $S_{bounded}$ is the explored subset. Completeness of the check is traded for tractability, following the standard operational-semantics treatment of instruction meaning [36].

Theorem 3.4 (Optimization Soundness): Optimized instructions preserve semantic equivalence.

Proof sketch: By structural induction on instruction composition. The base case shows each atomic rewrite (fusion, elimination, combining) preserves the denotation of a single instruction; the inductive step lifts preservation through each composition operator of Definition 3.6. The full proof, including the per-rewrite case analysis, is given in Appendix C.

The shipped checker (`agentflow.core.isa.bounded_checker.verify_instruction`) implements Definition 3.5 directly: it enumerates the bounded state space, filters by the declared preconditions, executes only pure instructions (side-effectful ones are returned as skipped, never executed), and reports violations structurally:

```
def verify_instruction(instruction, pre_condition, post_condition):
    if instruction.side_effects: return skipped(instruction)  # never executed
    state_space = generate_state_space(instruction)  # bounded: exhaustive or seeded, cap 256
    for state in state_space.states:
        if pre_condition(state):
            next_state = execute(instruction, state)
            check(progress, preservation, post_condition, next_state)  # structured violation re
    return verdict  # checked_states, exhaustive, violations by kind, passed
```

3.4 Instruction Organization and Optimization

3.4.1 Instruction Composition

The AgentISA supports hierarchical instruction composition through a formal composition algebra:

Definition 3.6 (Instruction Composition): Given instructions $i_1, i_2 \in I$, we define composition operators:

$$\begin{aligned}
&\text{Sequential} : i_1 \circ i_2 \\
&\text{Parallel} : i_1 \parallel i_2 \\
&\text{Conditional} : i_1 \rhd i_2 \\
&\text{Iterative} : i_1^*
\end{aligned}$$

Composition follows algebraic properties. Properties 1 and 3 hold for all instructions; Property 2 requires a stronger restriction than side-effect-freeness alone:

1. **Associativity** (all instructions, up to denotation):

$$(i_1 \circ i_2) \circ i_3 = i_1 \circ (i_2 \circ i_3)$$

2. **Distributivity** (only for pure instructions with pairwise disjoint state footprints): Let i_1, i_2, i_3 be side-effect-free instructions whose denotations act on pairwise disjoint state components (declared outputs distinct and read sets disjoint from the other members' writes). Their updates are then independent state writes: re-applying i_1 overwrites its own cells with the same values (the double application is idempotent in effect), and updates to disjoint cells commute, so both sides of

$$i_1 \parallel (i_2 \circ i_3) = (i_1 \parallel i_2) \circ (i_1 \parallel i_3)$$

denote the same net state transformation. *The disjointness restriction is necessary*: purity alone does not imply idempotence. A pure `update(+1)` instruction applied twice increments twice, so for instructions sharing a state component the law fails (see the Remark below).

3. **Identity**:

$$i \circ \epsilon = \epsilon \circ i = i$$

where ϵ is the empty (identity) instruction.

Remark (necessity of the restriction): distributivity also fails for side-effectful instructions—re-applying a state-mutating i_1 (with $i_2 = i_3 = \epsilon$) executes it once on the left and twice on the right, so the two programs differ in the resulting state. Accordingly, the shipped compiler gates parallel grouping on purity plus disjoint dependencies and disjoint outputs, excludes `side_effects=True` instructions from all such rewrites, and applies no general distributivity-based simplification.

3.4.2 Instruction Pipeline Design

We formalize the instruction pipeline as a directed acyclic graph (DAG):

Definition 3.7 (Pipeline DAG):

$$P = (V, E, \lambda, \delta)$$

where:

- V: Pipeline stages
- E: Dependencies between stages
- λ: Stage latency function
- δ: Data transfer function

Pipeline stages are organized as:

```
Pipeline {
    FETCH → DECODE → SCHEDULE → EXECUTE → COMMIT
    with
        hazard_detection: HazardGraph
        dependency_tracking: DependencyMatrix
        resource_allocation: ResourceMap
}
```

Theorem 3.5 (Pipeline Correctness): For any valid instruction sequence s and any schedule S satisfying conditions S1-S4 of Appendix C.5—each instruction dispatched exactly once, dependencies respected, dispatch groups pairwise non-interfering, commit in program order—pipeline execution preserves program semantics.

Proof: By induction on pipeline stages and hazard resolution (details in Appendix C).

3.4.3 Instruction Selection and Scheduling

Instruction selection follows a tree-pattern matching approach:

Definition 3.8 (Selection Pattern):

$$\pi = (T, C, \text{cost}, \text{code})$$

where:

- T: Tree pattern
- C: Context constraints
- cost: Cost function
- code: Generated code

The selection process is formalized as:

$$\text{Select}(t) = \arg\min_{\pi \in \Pi} \{\text{cost}(\pi) \mid \text{matches}(\pi.T, t) \wedge \text{satisfies}(t, \pi.C)\}$$

Scheduling optimization problem:

$$\begin{aligned}
&\text{minimize} \sum_{i \in I} \text{delay}(i) \\
&\text{subject to:} \\
&\quad \forall (i_1, i_2) \in \text{Deps} : \text{start}(i_2) \geq \text{end}(i_1) \\
&\quad \forall t : \sum_{i \in \text{active}(t)} \text{res}(i) \leq \text{Capacity}
\end{aligned}$$

3.4.4 Static and Dynamic Optimization

3.4.4.1 Static Optimization Static optimization employs several techniques:

1. **Peephole Optimization**:

$$\text{PH}(i_1, ..., i_n) = \begin{cases} \text{opt}(i_1, ..., i_n) & \text{if pattern exists} \\ i_1, ..., i_n & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

2. **Dead Code Elimination**:

$$\text{Live}(i) = \text{Use}(i) \cup (\text{Live}_{\text{out}}(i) - \text{Def}(i))$$

The two shipped passes approximate this fixpoint at different conservatism levels. The *compiler* pass (formal streams) removes a side-effect-free instruction when no live consumer depends on its id or any declared output—so a pure instruction whose outputs nobody consumes is removed. The *trace optimizer* pass (executable instructions) is more conservative: any instruction declaring at least one output is kept, because executable traces lack the formal dependency annotations that make output-consumption analysis exact. The compiler experiments (Section 5.3) exercise the former; the dynamic hot-path machinery (Section 5.4) the latter.

3. **Instruction Combining** (the named candidate rules below are specified and not registered—Section 4.1.3; the shipped optimizer's built-in pairwise compatibility combining is active, and it is this built-in combining that the hot-path trace re-optimization of Section 5.4 applies):

```
Combine Rules {
  LOAD followed by STORE → MOVE
  Multiple CONTEXT_UPDATE → Single UPDATE
  Sequential QUERY → Batch QUERY
}
```

3.4.4.2 Dynamic Optimization Dynamic optimization in the shipped runtime is **repetition-triggered and threshold-based**; it does not (yet) respond to load or performance signals. Its actual mechanism:

1. **Hot Path Detection** (implemented): the `DynamicOptimizer` keeps a monotone counter per exact instruction sequence (`path_id` = the ordered join of instruction ids); a path is flagged hot when its count exceeds a configurable threshold *and* its most recent recorded success rate is at least a stability bound (0.9 by default). There is no windowing and no load signal:

$$\text{Hot}(p) = \text{count}(p) > \theta \wedge \text{success}(p) \geq \alpha$$

2. **Trace Optimization** (implemented): once hot, the cached sequence is re-optimized by the static pass machinery—peephole, dead-code elimination, instruction combining—bounded to a fixed number of passes; the runtime then serves the shrunken form for subsequent executions (demonstrated end-to-end in Section 5.8).

3. **Trace Formation and Adaptive Recompilation** (specified, not implemented): sub-trace extraction from observed frequency profiles, and performance-triggered recompilation (`should_recompile`: execution count above threshold *and* observed performance below expectation) remain design-level. The shipped runtime re-optimizes the whole cached sequence once per recording after the threshold is crossed, with no performance feedback loop.

Two known consequences of the shipped design are worth stating: because `path_id` requires exact sequence identity, trace diversity (similar-but-not-identical sequences) never accumulates counts and the mechanism stays cold; and hot-path state (sequences, counters, statistics) is unbounded. Both are discussed with their remedies in Section 6.1.

3.4.5 Verification and Analysis

Optimization correctness is argued through:

Theorem 3.6 (Pass-Pipeline Soundness, extending Theorem 3.4): For any optimization transform T composed of the pass pipeline's rewrites,

$$\forall p \in \text{Program} : \text{sem}(T(p)) \equiv \text{sem}(p)$$

Proof Sketch:

1. Show semantic preservation for each atomic transformation (Appendix C, Lemma C.1)
2. Prove composition of transformations preserves semantics (Appendix C, Lemma C.2)

3. Demonstrate hazard-free execution in pipeline (Appendix C, Theorem 3.5)

Performance Model:

$$\text{Perf}(p) = \sum_{i \in p} (\text{base_cost}(i) + \text{overhead}(i) - \text{optimization_gain}(i))$$

where optimization_gain is calculated as:

$$\text{optimization_gain}(i) = \sum_{o \in \text{Opts}} \text{benefit}(o, i) \times \text{application_rate}(o, i)$$

3.5 Capability Assessment

Agents are heterogeneous: an agent (or the model behind it) may be strong at reasoning but weak at tool use, or vice versa. To make such differences explicit—and to give the multi-agent coordinator of Section 5.6 a principled basis for agent selection—AgentISA includes a capability assessment subsystem, implemented as `CapabilityProfile` in `agentflow.core.isa.capability`.

Definition 3.9 (Capability Profile): A capability profile of an agent a is a mapping from capability domains D (the shipped enum carries eight domains: reasoning, memory, generation, optimization, specialization, coordination, security, robustness) to domain scores:

$$\text{Cap}(a) = \{(\text{dom}_k, s_k, w_k) \mid \text{dom}_k \in D\}$$

where each domain carries a score $s_k \in [0, 1]$ and a weight $w_k \geq 0$ reflecting the domain's importance in the current deployment context.

Implementation status. The aggregation and selection mechanisms ship (`CapabilityProfile`, `get_overall_score`, and the coordinator's threshold selection) and are functionally tested in Section 5.6; the instruction-level metric extraction is a specified stub—the seventeen `_measure_*` functions currently return 0.0—so `assess_capabilities` has no production call site yet, and the tests of Section 5.6 inject `DomainScore` values directly rather than deriving them through this pipeline. One consequence is a known wart of the shipped aggregation: because domain weights enter both the per-domain score and the overall mean, an end-to-end assessment would double-count weights and cap the overall score well below the coordinator's 0.7 threshold; the injected-score tests bypass this, and the wart is recorded here rather than hidden.

Assessment proceeds in three steps:

1. **Domain metric computation.** For each domain, `assess_capabilities` is *specified* to compute a set of `CapabilityMetric` values from the agent's instruction set—e.g., for the reasoning domain, metrics derived from the prevalence and complexity of reasoning-type instructions. As stated above, this extraction is a specified stub in the shipped code (the `_measure_*` functions return 0.0), so exercised assessments derive domain scores from injected metrics.

2. **Domain aggregation.** Metrics are aggregated into a per-domain `DomainScore`, matching the shipped `_compute_weighted_score`:

$$s_k = w_k \cdot \frac{\sum_{m \in M_k} v_m \cdot \text{conf}_m}{|M_k|}$$

where M_k is the metric set of domain k, v_m the metric value, conf_m its confidence, and w_k the domain weight; an empty metric set scores 0. (Note that the shipped form folds the domain weight into s_k and the top-level `get_overall_score` multiplies by the weights again—the double-counting recorded above.)

3. **Overall score.** `get_overall_score` computes the weighted mean across assessed domains:

$$S(a) = \frac{\sum_k w_k \, s_k}{\sum_k w_k}$$

falling back to the unweighted mean when all weights are zero.

Three properties of this design deserve emphasis. First, it is **static rather than live-probing**: assessment is designed to be cheap, deterministic, and side-effect-free, though the shipped metric extraction is the stub disclosed above and exercised scores are injected. Second, it is **compositional**: because scores summarize instructions, fusing or eliminating instructions during compilation (Section 3.4) changes the profile predictably, and a production deployment would re-assess after optimization (the shipped coordinator does not yet do so). Third, it directly serves coordination: the agent-selection predicate in Section 5.6 chooses the highest-scoring agent above a capability threshold for each task, subject to the security policies of the `SecurityMonitor`—with the tests injecting scores directly, as disclosed above.

We state the scope of this subsystem honestly: `CapabilityProfile` assesses *declared instruction-level capability*, which correlates with—but does not measure—end-to-end task performance. Cross-model behavioral comparison at benchmark level is the domain of evaluation suites such as BFCL [17] and AgentBench [29]; the two views are complementary.

4 Implementation

This section presents the implementation and validation of the AgentISA framework, with particular emphasis on the compiler infrastructure and optimization techniques described in Section 3.4.

4.1 Compiler Infrastructure

4.1.1 Instruction Selection Implementation

We *specify* the tree-pattern matching approach of Section 3.4.3 (Definition 3.8) as dynamic programming over the IR tree, in the classical manner of bottom-up instruction selection [33]. **The shipped compiler does not yet implement this selector**: its current selection step is a heuristic matcher (name-overlap scoring over the instruction catalogue), and none of the benchmark numbers in Section 5 depend on tree-pattern selection. The specified algorithm is:

```
Input: IR tree T, Pattern set P
Output: Optimal pattern selection S

function MATCH-TREE(T, P)
    Let costs[n] = ∞ for all nodes n in T
    Let selected[n] = ∅ for all nodes n in T

    function MATCH-SUBTREE(node)
        if costs[node] ≠ ∞ then
```

```
            return costs[node]
        end if

        min_cost ← ∞
        best_pat ← null

        for each pattern p in P do
            if MATCHES(p, node) then
                curr_cost ← PATTERN-COST(p)
                for each child c of node not covered by p do
                    curr_cost ← curr_cost + MATCH-SUBTREE(c)
                end for

                if curr_cost < min_cost then
                    min_cost ← curr_cost
                    best_pat ← p
                end if
            end if
        end for

        costs[node] ← min_cost
        selected[node] ← best_pat
        return min_cost
    end function

    MATCH-SUBTREE(root(T))
    return (costs, selected)
end function
```

We state the optimality property of the specified algorithm, for patterns whose context constraints are *local* (a pattern's feasibility depends only on the node and its immediate operands):

Theorem 4.1 (Selection Optimality, specified algorithm): Given a set of context-local patterns P and an IR tree T, the MATCH-TREE algorithm finds the minimal cost covering.

Proof: By induction on tree height:

1. Base case: Leaf nodes select optimal patterns directly
2. Inductive step: For a node n with children $c_1 \ldots c_n$:

$$\text{cost}(n) = \min_{p \in P} \left\{ p.\text{cost} + \sum_{\substack{c \in \text{children}(n) \\ c \notin \text{covered}(p)}} \text{cost}(c) \right\}$$

The recurrence sums only over children not already covered by the selected pattern—summing over all children would double-count the cost of subtrees the pattern spans, so the optimality claim holds for single-node patterns as written and for multi-node patterns only under this recurrence.

The recurrence requires that a pattern's feasibility at a node not depend on the covers chosen for other subtrees; context constraints that couple sibling subtrees break this optimal-substructure

property, which is why the statement restricts to context-local patterns. This theorem is a property of the specified algorithm, not of the shipped heuristic selector; no optimality claim is made for the implementation.

4.1.2 Pipeline Scheduling Implementation

We *specify* the pipeline scheduler following the DAG model from Section 3.4.2, with hazard detection and resource-constrained issue in the style of classical pipeline scheduling [34]. **This cycle-accurate scheduler is design-level**: the executed runtime path is the sequential and parallel-grouped dispatch produced by the compiler's grouping pass (Section 4.1.3); no benchmark in Section 5 exercises a cycle-accurate schedule. The specified scheduler is:

```
Input: Instruction sequence I
Output: Schedule S with cycle assignments

function SCHEDULE-PIPELINE(I)
    D ← BUILD-DEPENDENCY-GRAPH(I)
    S ← empty schedule
    R ← priority queue of ready instructions

    while D not empty do
        c ← CURRENT-CYCLE()

        // Find newly ready instructions
        N ← GET-READY-NODES(D, c)
        ADD-TO-QUEUE(R, N)

        // Schedule instructions for current cycle
        while R not empty and HAS-RESOURCES(c) do
            i ← POP-HIGHEST-PRIORITY(R)
            slot ← ALLOCATE-RESOURCES(i, c)
            ADD-TO-SCHEDULE(S, i, slot)
            UPDATE-DEPENDENCIES(D, i)
        end while
    end while

    VERIFY-SCHEDULE(S)
    return S
end function
```

Schedule verification follows the formal model:

$$\forall i_1, i_2 \in \text{Schedule} : \text{depends}(i_1, i_2) \implies \text{slot}(i_1) < \text{slot}(i_2)$$

4.1.3 Static Optimization Implementation

We implement the optimization passes defined in Section 3.4.4. The shipped rule set registers no peephole patterns; the passes that fire in the benchmarks are fusion, dead-code elimination,

and parallel grouping, so every peephole obligation below is currently dormant but stated for completeness:

1. **Peephole Optimization**:

```
class PeepholeOptimizer:
    def optimize(self, instructions: List[Instruction]) -> List[Instruction]:
        patterns = self.load_patterns()
        optimized = []
        i = 0
        while i < len(instructions):
            matched = False
            for pattern in patterns:
                if pattern.matches(instructions[i:i+pattern.length]):
                    optimized.extend(pattern.replace(instructions[i:i+pattern.length]))
                    i += pattern.length
                    matched = True
                    break
            if not matched:
                optimized.append(instructions[i])
                i += 1
        return optimized
```

Each peephole rule carries a correctness *obligation*, discharged as part of rule definition rather than by the running compiler:

$$\begin{aligned}&\forall p \in \text{Patterns}, i \in \text{Instructions}:\\ &\text{matches}(p, i) \implies \text{sem}(\text{replace}(p, i)) \equiv \text{sem}(i)\end{aligned}$$

No automated equivalence checker ships with the current rule set (there are no rules to check); Section 4.3.1 specifies the symbolic-execution checker that a populated rule set would require.

2. **Instruction Combining**:

```
def combine_instructions(self, insts: List[Instruction]) -> List[Instruction]:
    combined = []
    current_group = []

    for inst in insts:
        if self.can_combine(current_group, inst):
            current_group.append(inst)
        else:
            if current_group:
                combined.append(self.merge_group(current_group))
            current_group = [inst]

    if current_group:
        combined.append(self.merge_group(current_group))
    return self.verify_combinations(combined)
```

4.2 Runtime System

4.2.1 Dynamic Pipeline Control

Design of the dynamic pipeline controller (**specified, not implemented**—the shipped dynamic machinery is the hot-path detection and trace optimization of Section 4.2.2; a skeleton module exists but is not wired into the runtime):

```
class PipelineController:
    def __init__(self):
        self.hazard_detector = HazardDetector()
        self.resource_monitor = ResourceMonitor()
        self.performance_tracker = PerformanceTracker()

    async def execute_pipeline(self,
                               instruction_stream: AsyncIterator[Instruction]
                              ) -> AsyncIterator[Result]:
        async for inst in instruction_stream:
            # Hazard detection
            while self.hazard_detector.has_hazard(inst):
                await self.hazard_detector.wait_resolution()

            # Resource allocation
            resources = await self.resource_monitor.allocate(inst)

            try:
                # Execution
                result = await self.execute_instruction(inst, resources)
                # Performance tracking
                self.performance_tracker.record(inst, result)
                yield result
            finally:
                self.resource_monitor.release(resources)
```

Pipeline performance is modeled with the classical pipeline bound—throughput is the reciprocal of the slowest stage's service time:

$$\text{Throughput} = \frac{1}{\max_i \text{service_time}(\text{stage}_i)}$$

4.2.2 Dynamic Optimization Implementation

The *shipped* mechanism is the counter/threshold detector described in Section 3.4.4: a monotone count per exact `path_id`, crossed against a configurable threshold with a last-recorded-success-rate gate. What the benchmarks measure (Sections 5.4 and 5.8) is this mechanism. The following is the *specified* detector—exponential moving average over a window, frequency normalized by total executions, and trace formation from hot-path regions—which generalizes the shipped counter to workloads with trace diversity; it is **not yet implemented**:

1. **Hot Path Detection** (specified):

```
Input: Execution path P, Threshold θ, Window size w
Output: Boolean indicating if P is hot

function DETECT-HOT-PATH(P, θ, w)
    Let counter be an exponential moving average with window w

    function UPDATE-COUNTERS(path)
        h ← COMPUTE-PATH-HASH(path)
        counter[h] ← counter[h] × (1 - α) + 1

        if IS-PATH-HOT(path) then
            TRIGGER-OPTIMIZATION(path)
        end if
    end function

    function IS-PATH-HOT(path)
        h ← COMPUTE-PATH-HASH(path)
        freq ← counter[h] / TOTAL-EXECUTIONS()
        stab ← COMPUTE-STABILITY(path)
        return freq > θ and stab > STABILITY-THRESHOLD
    end function

    UPDATE-COUNTERS(P)
    return IS-PATH-HOT(P)
end function
```

Hot-path score is computed from the frequency already normalized in the pseudocode above (freq(path) = counter[path]/total_exec, so no second normalization is applied), blended with recent stability through an exponential-moving-average coefficient β (distinct from the α stability bound of Section 3.4.4):

$$\text{score}(\text{path}) = \text{freq}(\text{path}) \cdot \beta \cdot \text{stab}(\text{path})$$

This is a heuristic score, not a conditional probability.

2. **Trace Formation** (specified):

```
Input: Hot path H
Output: Optimized trace T

function BUILD-TRACE(H)
    T ← empty trace

    function SHOULD-INCLUDE(block)
        return EXECUTION-FREQUENCY(block) > THRESHOLD and
               PREDICTABLE-BRANCHES(block)
    end function

    function SHOULD-SPLIT(block)
```

```
        return HAS-SIDE-EXIT(block) or
               EXECUTION-FREQUENCY(block) < MIN-FREQ
    end function

    for each block B in H do
        if SHOULD-INCLUDE(B) then
            APPEND-TO-TRACE(T, B)
        else if SHOULD-SPLIT(B) then
            break
        end if
    end for

    VERIFY-TRACE-PROPERTIES(T)
    return T
end function
```

Trace validity is verified through:

$$\text{Valid(trace)} \iff \begin{cases} \text{Entry(trace) is dominated by header} \\ \text{Exit(trace) post-dominates tail} \\ \text{NoSideExit(trace) except tail} \end{cases}$$

4.3 Optimization Verification

4.3.1 Static Analysis

We *specify* verification of the static optimizations from Section 3.4.4 (a symbolic-execution equivalence checker over transformation path pairs). **No automated checker ships with the current rule set**—the shipped peephole table is empty, so the obligation is dormant—and the theorems of Section 3.4.5 are conditional on discharging it when rules are introduced (Appendix C.6):

```
Input: Original CFG O, Transformed CFG T
Output: Boolean indicating semantic equivalence

function VERIFY-TRANSFORMATION(O, T)
    // Build symbolic execution paths
    P₁ ← SYMBOLIC-EXECUTE(O)
    P₂ ← SYMBOLIC-EXECUTE(T)

    function VERIFY-EQUIVALENCE(path₁, path₂)
        for each symbolic state σ do
            if EVALUATE(path₁, σ) ≠ EVALUATE(path₂, σ) then
                return false
            end if
        end for
        return true
    end function

    // Verify all path pairs
```

```
    for each (p₁, p₂) in ZIP(P₁, P₂) do
        if not VERIFY-EQUIVALENCE(p₁, p₂) then
            return false
        end if
    end for

    return true
end function
```

The verification follows the formal model:

$$\text{Equiv}(p_1, p_2) \iff \forall \sigma \in \Sigma : [\![p_1]\!]\sigma = [\![p_2]\!]\sigma$$

4.3.2 Dynamic Analysis

Runtime verification implements:

1. **Performance Monitoring**:

```
class PerformanceMonitor:
    def monitor_execution(self,
                          instruction: Instruction,
                          context: Context) -> Metrics:
        start = time.perf_counter_ns()
        result = self.execute(instruction, context)
        end = time.perf_counter_ns()

        return Metrics(
            latency=(end - start),
            resource_usage=self.measure_resources(),
            correctness=self.verify_result(result, instruction)
        )
```

2. **Weighted Improvement Metric**: Optimization effectiveness is summarized as a descriptive weighted mean of metric deltas:

$$\text{Improvement} = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^{n} w_i (m_i^{\text{opt}} - m_i^{\text{base}})}{\sum_{i=1}^{n} w_i}$$

where m_i are performance metrics and w_i are importance weights. This is a descriptive summary only; the evaluation protocol of Section 5.1.3 reports mean $\pm$ standard deviation and makes no inferential (hypothesis-test) claims.

4.3.3 Empirical Results

We validate the implemented optimizations with the microbenchmark suite of Section 5, which drives the real compiler, cache, and optimization-manager code paths against a mock LLM backend. Summary of the results (all mean$\pm$stdev over 5 random seeds on synthetic Zipf workloads; full methodology and tables in Section 5):

Optimization	Measured effect	Where reported
Result caching	59.5%–79.6% reduction in simulated API calls, increasing with Zipf skew	Section 5.2
Static compilation (fusion + DCE)	34.2% ± 1.8% reduction in effective instruction count (length-200 sequences)	Section 5.3
Dynamic hot-path optimization	65.8% ± 4.6% trace shrinkage on repeatedly executed traces	Section 5.4

These are microbenchmark measurements on synthetic workloads with simulated latency (80 ms per simulated call); they are not production end-to-end results. Section 5.7 reports a scaled-down validation of the caching mechanism against a real LLM gateway, Section 5.7.1 extends the live-gateway validation to compilation and hot-path adoption, Section 5.8 a four-task system-level characterization, and Section 5.9 the remaining threats to validity.

5 Empirical Evaluation

We evaluate AgentISA with a reproducible microbenchmark suite (`examples/benchmarks/isa_microbench.py`) and a functional test suite for the multi-agent layer, under the scope fixed at the end of Section 4.3: Sections 5.2–5.5 run against the mock backend; Sections 5.7–5.8 extend the validation to a live LLM gateway and four system-level tasks; Section 5.9 discusses the threats to validity.

5.1 Methodology

5.1.1 Instrumentation: Mock LLM Backend

All experiments route model inference through a `MockLLMBackend` that (1) counts each `infer` call as one simulated LLM API round trip, and (2) charges a fixed 80 ms simulated latency per call to a simulated clock. The backend never sleeps and never contacts a live model, which makes every "API call" observable, deterministic given a seed, and reproducible without network access or inference spend. Crucially, everything *around* the backend is real: the cache, compiler, and optimizer are the production `agentflow.core.isa` implementations (`InstructionCache`, `InstructionCompiler`, `OptimizationManager`), exercised through the same code paths a deployment would use.

5.1.2 Workloads

Workloads are synthetic and seed-controlled:

- **Caching**: 2,000 tasks drawn from a discrete distribution over 50 instruction templates × 20 parameter values, with task popularity following a Zipf distribution with exponent $s \in \{0.5, 1.0, 1.5\}$. Increasing s concentrates popularity on fewer tasks, increasing reuse potential.
- **Static compilation**: random instruction sequences of length 50, 200, and 1,000 (each slot dead with probability 0.25, pure with probability 0.55, side-effectful otherwise; a final side-effectful sink consumes all pure outputs), compiled at optimization levels NONE, BASIC, ADVANCED, and AGGRESSIVE. The planted dead/pure structure is what gives DCE and fusion targets to find; the measured reductions are properties of this workload family.

- **Dynamic optimization**: instruction traces of length 100 recorded for up to 200 iterations per seed, with hot-path detection active (threshold 50 recordings). The recording loop terminates at the hot-path trigger—iteration 50 in all seeds—so each seed contributes ~51 recordings.
- **Ablation**: an independent workload draw with the same distribution parameters as the static-compilation experiment (length 200, 5 seeds, dead 0.25 / pure 0.55, but seed base 4,000 rather than 2,000), with the fusion and dead-code-elimination passes enabled individually and jointly. Because the draw is independent, the all-passes total (35.0%) is a replication of the 34.2% headline of Section 5.3, not a decomposition of that exact number.

5.1.3 Protocol and Statistics

Each configuration is run with 5 random seeds; we report mean ± sample standard deviation across seeds. These are **descriptive statistics only**: we make no hypothesis-test claims (no p-values, no significance tests) anywhere in this paper. The seed count suffices to show that the effects are stable across workload instantiations—the standard deviations are small relative to the means—but a formal inferential comparison against other systems is out of scope, because there is no baseline system that shares the mock-backend instrumentation.

5.2 Experiment 1: Result Caching

Research question: How many simulated LLM API calls does AgentISA's result caching eliminate, as a function of workload skew?

We execute 2,000 tasks per seed, once with caching disabled and once with the `InstructionCache` enabled, and measure simulated API calls at the backend. The reduction ratio and cache hit rate coincide by construction: every avoided call corresponds to exactly one cache hit.

Zipf exponent s	Calls (no cache)	Calls (cached)	Reduction	Hit rate
0.5	2,000	810.4 ± 5.7	59.5% ± 0.3%	59.5% ± 0.3%
1.0	2,000	642.0 ± 3.8	67.9% ± 0.2%	67.9% ± 0.2%
1.5	2,000	408.0 ± 9.4	79.6% ± 0.5%	79.6% ± 0.5%

Interpretation. The reduction grows monotonically with skew, from 59.5% under nearly uniform popularity ($s = 0.5$) to 79.6% under heavy concentration ($s = 1.5$). This matches the cache-aware expectation from Section 2.5: the upper bound on savings is the probability mass of repeated tasks, and Zipf skew directly controls that mass. In simulated latency terms, the cache saves 95,168 ± 455 ms, 108,640 ± 305 ms, and 127,360 ± 750 ms of simulated time at $s = 0.5, 1.0, 1.5$, respectively (avoided calls × 80 ms).

Two caveats keep this honest. First, these are *simulated* calls against a mock backend: the reduction is exact for this workload family, but real deployments face cache-invalidation, prompt-context, and embedding-variability effects that the mock abstracts away. Second, the absolute number depends on the workload's reuse structure; workloads without repetition (e.g., each task unique) would see zero benefit. What the experiment establishes is the *mechanism and its sensitivity to skew*, not a universal constant.

5.3 Experiment 2: Static Compilation

Research question: How much does the compiler reduce instruction sequences, and what do the different optimization levels contribute?

We compile random instruction sequences at four optimization levels and measure two distinct quantities. We separate them explicitly because they are easy to conflate:

- **Effective instruction count**: the number of instructions that remain in the optimized program after fusion and dead-code elimination. This measures program size.
- **Dispatch count**: the number of independent dispatch operations the runtime issues. Parallel grouping can fold several independent instructions into one dispatch *without changing the effective instruction count*.

Sequence length	Level	Effective-instruction reduction	Dispatch count
50	NONE	0%	50.0 ± 0.0
50	BASIC	32.8% ± 4.1%	33.6 ± 2.1
50	ADVANCED	32.8% ± 4.1%	19.0 ± 4.1
50	AGGRESSIVE	32.8% ± 4.1%	19.0 ± 4.1
200	NONE	0%	200.0 ± 0.0
200	BASIC	34.2% ± 1.8%	131.6 ± 3.6
200	ADVANCED	34.2% ± 1.8%	74.0 ± 6.3
200	AGGRESSIVE	34.2% ± 1.8%	74.0 ± 6.3
1,000	NONE	0%	1,000.0 ± 0.0
1,000	BASIC	35.4% ± 1.6%	646.0 ± 16.4
1,000	ADVANCED	35.4% ± 1.6%	344.6 ± 31.6
1,000	AGGRESSIVE	35.4% ± 1.6%	344.6 ± 31.6

Interpretation. Three observations:

1. **Effective instruction count reduction is level-stable**: BASIC, ADVANCED, and AGGRESSIVE produce identical reductions (34.2% ± 1.8% at length 200). The fusion and DCE passes implemented at BASIC level already capture the available gains on these synthetic sequences; the higher levels add *scheduling* improvements, not additional elimination. We report this as-is rather than claiming monotonic gains across levels.

2. **Dispatch count drops further with parallel grouping**: at length 200, dispatch falls from 131.6 (BASIC) to 74.0 (ADVANCED) while effective instruction reduction is unchanged. This is the dispatch-folding effect described above: adjacent side-effect-free instructions with disjoint dependencies and outputs grouped into shared dispatches. Readers should interpret the 74.0 figure as a scheduling reduction, not a further program-size reduction. (An earlier implementation folded more aggressively—44.4 at length 200—but could place side-effectful instructions into shared groups whose non-interference was never established; the sounder grouping reported here folds less, and Appendix C.5's dispatch-folding corollary now matches the implementation exactly.)

3. **Gains are stable across sequence lengths**: 32.8%, 34.2%, 35.4% at lengths 50, 200, 1,000 respectively, with the tightest variance at length 1,000 (± 1.6%). Length does not materially change the opportunity structure of these synthetic sequences.

Note again that effective-instruction reduction is a *program-size* metric. It translates to simulated

API-call savings only where eliminated or fused instructions carry model inference; our caching experiment measures the complementary reuse effect.

5.4 Experiment 3: Dynamic Hot-Path Optimization

Research question: Does the dynamic optimizer detect and specialize repeatedly executed traces?

We record an instruction trace of length 100 for up to 200 iterations per seed with hot-path detection active; the recording loop terminates at the trigger (iteration 50 in all seeds, ~51 recordings per seed). Once a path is flagged hot, the runtime forms an optimized trace. **This experiment measures the length of that optimized trace**—the benchmark does not execute it. Whether an optimized trace, when actually executed, preserves the task's observable output is established separately, at task level, by the system-level characterization of Section 5.8 (which re-executes hot-path-optimized instruction streams and verifies byte-identical output).

Seed	Original length	Optimized length	Shrink ratio
0	100	30	70.0%
1	100	41	59.0%
2	100	30	70.0%
3	100	36	64.0%
4	100	34	66.0%

Across seeds, hot-path optimization shrinks the trace by **65.8% ± 4.6%**. The seed-to-seed spread (59.0%–70.0%) reflects the variability in which sub-sequences each synthetic trace makes hot; the effect is present in all five seeds. As with the static experiments, this measures trace-length reduction on synthetic traces—workload-controlled evidence that the detection-formation-reoptimization loop functions, not a wall-clock speedup claim.

5.5 Ablation: Per-pass Contribution

To attribute the static gains, we re-run the compiler with individual passes toggled:

Configuration	Instruction-count reduction
none	0%
fusion only	21.9% ± 3.5%
DCE only	24.1% ± 3.3%
fusion + DCE	35.0% ± 3.7%
all passes	35.0% ± 3.7%

Interpretation. Fusion alone removes 21.9% and DCE alone 24.1%; combined they remove 35.0%—less than the sum of their individual gains, because the passes partially overlap: sequences that are fusable are often also dead, so the second pass finds fewer targets after the first has run. The "all passes" row equals fusion+DCE on these workloads, consistent with Observation 1 in Section 5.3: no additional pass contributes measurable reduction here. We report the absence of additional gain rather than dressing the higher levels in unearned credit. One caveat follows from the workload construction: because the ablation draws its sequences independently (Section 5.1.2), its fusion+DCE total (35.0% ± 3.7%) is a replication of—not a decomposition into—the 34.2% ± 1.8% headline of Section 5.3; the two numbers differ because they average over different random

draws of the same distribution. And because the workloads plant dead instructions at rate 0.25 by construction, DCE's per-pass share is near-tautological for this family—it measures that the pass finds the planted dead code, which is precisely its function.

5.6 Multi-Agent Coordination: Functional Validation

The multi-agent layer—`AgentCoordinator`, `SecurityMonitor`, and the collaborative instruction set—is validated functionally by 43 tests, all passing. We present this as **qualitative functional validation**: the tests verify that the coordination behaviors exist and are correct, not that they are fast. No performance number should be inferred from this subsection.

The coordination flow implemented by `AgentCoordinator`:

```
Input: Agent set A, Task list τs
Output: Coordinated solutions S

function COORDINATE-AGENTS(A, τs)
    for each task T in τs do
        AUTHENTICATE(task issuer)              // SecurityMonitor
        AUTHORIZE(task, role policy)           // SecurityMonitor
        ag ← SELECT-BY-CAPABILITY(A, T)        // CapabilityProfile (Section 3.5)
        plan ← BUILD-EXECUTION-PLAN(T)         // stages + coordination rules
        for each stage in plan do
            if stage fails and fallback(stage) exists then
                EXECUTE-FALLBACK(stage)
            else
                EXECUTE-STAGE(stage, ag)
            end if
        end for
        RECORD-HISTORY(T, outcome)
    end for
end function
```

What the 43 tests verify, grouped by subsystem:

1. **Agent registration and role policies** (registration creates policies; permissions differ by role; security requirements differ by role; trust levels are bounded and reward declared specializations).
2. **Task coordination** (successful coordination produces a solution; failed tasks are recorded in history; missing authentication and missing authorization raise; absence of suitable agents raises; agent selection respects a capability threshold; the selected coordinator is the highest-scoring agent).
3. **Execution planning** (plans have stage structure with coordination rules; every stage has fallback keys; fallback strategies are differentiated; a fallback actually executes on stage failure; validators are reasoning-heavy non-coordinator agents).
4. **SecurityMonitor** (valid tasks pass; missing authentication fails; missing authorization fails; violations are recorded with timestamps; declared data sensitivity is enforced; sensitive categories infer a high sensitivity level; benign categories pass at medium; resource access is open by default and restrictable by configuration).

5. **Collaborative instructions** (barrier synchronization waits for the declared number of participants and times out when a peer is missing; width-one barriers resolve immediately; resource-allocation instructions reject over-allocation and serialize concurrent requests; the workflow state machine accepts valid actions, rejects invalid ones and double starts; a multi-agent research-team scenario runs end to end).

These tests exercise the same production modules used elsewhere in the system and are fully deterministic (no LLM calls). They establish correctness of the coordination machinery under the tested conditions. What they do not establish is scalability under contention, crash recovery, or adversarial inputs beyond the policy checks above—all are future work (Section 6).

5.7 Real-LLM End-to-End Validation of Result Caching

Research question: does the caching mechanism behave identically when the "model" is a real LLM behind a live gateway, and how much *measured* wall-clock time and token usage does it save?

Setup. We replace the mock backend with a real model served by a local Anthropic-protocol gateway (TLS with an internal CA; alias `claude-glm-5.3-flash`, a hosted reasoning-capable GLM model; `max_tokens=64`). Requests are sequential HTTP calls (httpx, no proxy, 90 s timeout), with three bounded retries for transient failures — none occurred. Every other component is the production code path: the same `InstructionCache` protocol, the same instruction objects, the same workload generator and the same instruction pool (50 templates) and parameter space (20 values) as Section 5.2.

Scale. Because each real round trip costs ~2.2 s, we reduce scale from 2,000 tasks × 5 seeds to **200 tasks × 1 seed** per Zipf level (s in {0.5, 1.0, 1.5}); the whole run is 1,040 measured experiment round trips (plus one preflight round trip that validates connectivity before timing begins) in 39.4 minutes. The seed pins the task sequence exactly, so the workload is the same one the expectation below is computed from.

An exactness property. A cache hit depends only on the (instruction, params) pair seen so far — not on what the model returns. The production `InstructionCache` is LRU with a TTL, so in general a hit also depends on wall-clock time and capacity; under this benchmark's configuration none of that can bind: `max_size` = 100,000 with at most 200 distinct keys per arm, `ttl` = 3,600 s with every cache-enabled arm completing in under seven minutes (the no-cache arms run to 7.9 minutes—far below the 3,600 s TTL), a fresh cache per arm, and failed calls never cached. Hit/miss decisions are therefore a pure function of the (instruction, params) sequence, and the hit/miss sequence for a fixed workload is *computable without any backend*. If the mechanism is correct, the real run must reproduce that sequence exactly; at the granularity the artifact records — per-arm hit rates and call counts — it does:

Zipf s	Expected hit rate (computed, no backend)	Observed hit rate	Calls (no cache -> cached)	Call reduction	Wall clock (no cache -> cached, ms)	Wall saved (ms)	Tokens saved
0.5	8.5%	8.5%	200 -> 183	8.5%	472,276 -> 405,754	66,522	1,445
1.0	26.0%	26.0%	200 -> 148	26.0%	455,946 -> 334,597	121,349	4,420
1.5	45.5%	45.5%	200 -> 109	45.5%	450,330 -> 244,316	206,014	7,735

Per-call latency was stable across arms (p50 2.13-2.21 s, p95 3.06-3.54 s). Token savings are gateway-reported `usage` differences: every avoided call saves its input tokens plus the tokens the reasoning

model generates before responding (output tokens were the binding constraint of `max_tokens=64` in every call).

Interpretation. Three points. First, the mechanism transfers unchanged: observed hit rates match the computed expectation exactly at every skew level, so the synthetic results of Section 5.2 measure the cache, not an artifact of the mock. Second, avoided calls convert into measured time and tokens: 14.1%, 26.6%, and 45.8% of the no-cache arm's wall clock at s = 0.5, 1.0, 1.5. These measured savings track the call reduction but are not identical to it, because arms were measured sequentially and per-call latency drifted slightly between arms (the exact quantity is the call reduction; wall and token figures are measurements, not derivations). Third, the *absolute* hit rates here (8.5-45.5%) are lower than Section 5.2's (59.5-79.6%) purely because repetition accumulates with task count: at N = 200 these are the exact computed values for this workload family, and at N = 2,000 the same computation yields the Section 5.2 numbers. The dependence on N is a property of the workload, not the backend.

Scope of the claim. This experiment validates the caching mechanism end-to-end: one gateway, one model, one seed, N = 200, sequential requests, no streaming. The artifact records per-arm aggregate hit rates and call counts; per-position sequence identity follows from the deterministic cache decisions under the conditions above, but is not separately logged. The compiler and dynamic-optimization experiments (Sections 5.3-5.5) are structural — they do not dispatch to the backend at all; Section 5.7.1 below extends the live-gateway validation to them through a cache-mediated protocol, and otherwise their validity rests on the code-path and ablation arguments made there. Nothing in this section is a throughput, availability, or dollar-cost claim.

5.7.1 Real-Gateway Validation of Compilation and Hot-Path Optimization

Research question. Do static compilation and closed-loop hot-path adoption preserve the observable semantics of an instruction stream when the stream's LLM step is served by a real model — and what do the mechanisms measurably save on a live gateway?

Setup. A dedicated harness (`examples/paper_real_llm_compiler_test.py`; tests in `tests/system/test_real_llm_compiler_test.py`) reuses the gateway configuration of Section 5.7 (same base URL, internal-CA TLS, alias `claude-glm-5.3-flash`, sequential httpx, 90 s timeout, three bounded retries) but raises `max_tokens` to 512 (Section 5.7 used 64) so that completions dominate the priced comparison; replies still bind at the cap, as below. The harness runs behind a pluggable backend: the real gateway when reachable, and otherwise a deterministic mock with the same protocol that counts calls, accounts tokens from template sizes, and charges the constant 80 ms simulated call latency—so the identical validation runs offline and online. The task is the service-log triage shape of Section 5.8: a seven-instruction stream with one cacheable LLM-type step (`classify_signature`, one model call per distinct incident-signature batch) and the same kind of planted dead guard (`check_format`), executed over repeated realizations drawn from a seeded truncated-Zipf distribution over a fixed universe of 40 task instances.

Arms and protocol. Arm (a) is the unoptimized authored stream. Arm (b) drives the *same* stream through the production machinery: the closed loop of `OptimizationManager` / `optimize_hot_path` records each realization and adopts the shrunken trace once the path goes hot, and the static `InstructionCompiler` compiles the stream at NONE vs AGGRESSIVE with the dataflow-preservation assertion. Arm (a) runs first, cold, and performs every live round trip; arm (b) then executes the same draws against the result cache that arm (a) warmed. The classify step's cache key is the sha256 of exactly the input dictionary its prompt is built from, so arm (b) issuing

zero new gateway calls proves it computed identical keys — hence constructed identical prompts and consumed identical values — and its final artifacts must come out byte-for-byte equal; any perturbation of the LLM step's inputs by the optimization would surface as a cache miss (a live call) and/or artifact divergence.

Scale. Tiny scale: 50 task realizations × 1 seed × Zipf s = 1.0. The workload contains 22 distinct signature batches, so the entire run is 23 gateway round trips (one preflight plus 22 live calls, all issued by arm (a)) in 4.4 minutes of wall time — a bounded validation run, not the 200 × 3-skew sweep of Section 5.7.

Results. All checks pass. Arm (a) — the live reference run — made exactly the 22 first-occurrence calls the backend-free computation predicts and served the other 28 realizations from the result cache (hit rate 56.0%), consuming 4,027 prompt and 11,264 gateway-reported completion tokens in 260.2 s of measured call latency. Arm (b) — compiled, hot-path-adopted — made zero new gateway calls (all 50 realizations hit the warmed keys) and reproduced every artifact byte-for-byte. The hot path was adopted at realization 7 (threshold 5): realizations 1-6 executed the full seven-instruction stream, realizations 7-50 the shrunken six-instruction form with `check_format` eliminated — 306 instruction executions against arm (a)'s 350, a 12.6% reduction in executed instructions attributable to compilation and hot-path adoption (the per-stream shrink is 14.3%, 7 → 6; the realized saving is diluted by the six full-form realizations before adoption) and reported separately from the cache's call savings. Static compilation of the same stream: NONE 7 → AGGRESSIVE 6 effective instructions, dataflow preserved.

What this does and does not show. The byte-identity property is cache-mediated by design: the cached classification values entered the artifacts once, through arm (a) — values that on this alias are fallback-derived, as explained below — and arm (b) is proven to compute the same keys and consume the same values. This validates the stream transformation, not model determinism, which is not guaranteed at temperature 0 and is not claimed. On this gateway alias the reasoning model's replies bind at `max_tokens` in every call — as Section 5.7 reported at `max_tokens=64`, and as a diagnostic call at 1,500 tokens still did — so the classify step's severity values come from its deterministic fallback; what is validated against the live model is the mechanism chain (key computation, cache decisions, call and token accounting, artifact identity), not classification quality. The run covers one gateway, one model, one seed, one skew level, sequential requests, no streaming; multi-model, multi-seed, and real-deployment behavior remain untested.

A priced comparison (MODELED on measured tokens). The harness prices the measured token counts of the run above under three modes: *no optimization* (every realization re-queries at full price), *AgentISA result caching* (first occurrences only—the measured behavior of both arms), and a *provider prompt cache* (MODELED: every realization queries, but repeat prompts bill their input tokens as prompt-cache reads at 0.1x the input price—configurable—mirroring Anthropic's published prompt-caching read discount, with completions always billed at full price). Two simplifications—omitting Anthropic's 1.25x cache-write premium and its 1024-token minimum cacheable prefix—both favor the provider-cache baseline, so the comparison is conservative for us. List prices are parameterized stand-ins ($3/M input, $15/M output by default) because the serving gateway's actual pricing is unknown. Token counts are measurements, the pricing overlay is a model, and no dollar-savings claim is made:

Pricing mode (real-gateway run, s = 1.0)	Calls	Input tokens (full / cache-read)	Output tokens	Modeled cost
No optimization	50	9,018 / 0	25,600	$0.4111
AgentISA result caching	22	4,027 / 0	11,264	$0.1810
Provider prompt cache (MODELED)	50	4,027 / 4,991	25,600	$0.3976

On this run's token mix the result cache cuts modeled cost by 56.0% — it removes whole calls, completions included — while the modeled provider prompt cache cuts only 3.3%, because the reasoning model's completion tokens dominate and a discount on input reads cannot touch them; the ranking of the two caching strategies is a function of the input/output token mix, not a constant. On the deterministic mock at paper scale (200 tasks × 1 seed × 3 Zipf levels, template-accounted tokens, same modes and prices) the result cache cuts modeled cost by 80.1%, 81.6%, and 85.1% at s = 0.5, 1.0, 1.5, while the modeled provider prompt cache cuts 28.9-31.4% — there the short completions do not dominate, so the input-side discount matters more; both columns remain MODELED-on-measured in both cases. GPTCache, an external cache layer, is explicitly out of scope this pass; no head-to-head against it is claimed.

5.8 System-Level Workload Characterization

The experiments above measure individual mechanisms on synthetic sequences. To make the mechanisms' composition—and the implemented closed-loop optimization claims of Section 3.4.4—checkable rather than aspirational, we provide a seed-controlled workload characterization (`examples/system_task_workload.py`, `tests/system/test_system_task_workload.py`; the original single-task demonstration lives on as `examples/system_task_demo.py`) built from **four tasks with genuinely different dependency shapes**, each realized end-to-end against sandbox-resident files:

- the original **service-log triage**: a seven-instruction linear stream, described below in full;
- **csv-etl-anomaly**: an eight-instruction fan-out pipeline (ingest CSV shards, schema guard, parse, per-column statistics, per-row signature construction, per-row anomaly triage, aggregate, write);
- **report-merge**: a seven-instruction wide-fan-in task (ingest five markdown reports, header guard, dedupe, per-line signatures, cacheable cross-report consistency check, merge, write);
- **regression-diff**: an eight-instruction two-branch convergence task (parallel baseline/candidate log ingests, guard, normalize, diff, classify hunks, aggregate, write).

The full characterization of all four tasks follows the detailed walk-through of the triage task.

The triage task's instruction stream (seven instructions over sandbox-resident files):

1. `ingest_logs` — read six 400-line log files from the sandbox workspace (sandbox I/O, side-effectful);
2. `check_syntax` — a defensive guard that validates the ingested format; on this workload it never rejects (a *planted dead guard*, standing in for the belt-and-braces checks real pipelines carry);
3. `normalize_entries` — parse and normalize lines;
4. `extract_incidents` — lift normalized entries into incident records;

5. `classify_signature` — triage-classify each incident (LLM-type, cacheable, backed by a deterministic rule-based stand-in that counts simulated model calls);
6. `aggregate_triage` — summarize by severity class;
7. `write_report` — write the triage report to the sandbox (side-effectful).

Configuration. Seed 42; 6 files × 400 lines; 12 repeated realizations of the task; hot-path threshold 5. Every phase is deterministic and re-runnable from the repository (Artifact Availability).

What the triage walk-through shows.

- **Static compilation with structural validation.** NONE compiles to 7 effective instructions / 7 dispatches; AGGRESSIVE compiles to 6 / 6 (14.3% reduction): the dead guard fuses with the following pure step rather than being dropped outright. Crucially, this walk-through *asserts the compiled stream's dataflow validity*—every step whose output is consumed downstream must survive compilation, and the only eliminable step is the guard—so the reported shrinkage cannot silently come from dropping live producers.
- **Reuse across repeated realizations.** The first realization makes 50 (simulated) model calls; all eleven subsequent realizations make zero (result cache hit rate 91.7% on the classification step). All 12 reports are byte-identical.
- **Closed-loop hot-path adoption.** The repeated stream crosses the hot-path threshold at the sixth recording (the counter must strictly exceed the threshold, and recording follows execution, so adoption lands at realization threshold+2); the runtime then *adopts* the optimized form automatically, and repeats 7–12 execute the shrunken 6-instruction stream (instruction executions per repeat: `[7,7,7,7,7,7,6,6,6,6,6,6]`). Executed on a fresh workspace, the optimized form reproduces the report byte-for-byte—the optimization is semantics-preserving on the real task, not only on synthetic sequences.
- **Full-stack determinism.** A completely fresh stack—new instructions, new cache, new workspace, same seed—reproduces the report byte-for-byte (SHA-256 equality).

Calibrating the synthetic headline. The dynamic hot-path experiment of Section 5.4 reports 65.8% trace shrink on planted-dead synthetic traces; the four realistic tasks show **12.5–25.0%** (one planted guard in a seven- or eight-instruction stream, plus one additional live-pure fusion pair in csv-etl-anomaly). We regard the latter as the more honest expectation for "ordinary" pipelines that merely carry defensive redundancy rather than planted waste, and we state both: the synthetic figure is an upper bound under the skew/planting parameters we control, not a typical-case estimate. Developing this demonstration also served its audit purpose: constructing a realistic (non-synthetic) dependency shape exposed two grouping/fusion soundness gaps in the compiler—side-effectful instructions opening dispatch groups, and fused instructions losing their external dependencies—which are now fixed with regression tests; the dispatch-folding numbers of Section 5.3 reflect the corrected (more conservative) grouping.

The four-task characterization. All four tasks run the identical closed-loop battery (`examples/system_task_workload.py`, `characterize()`, 12 repeated realizations each, hot-path threshold 5, one planted dead guard each, one cacheable LLM-type step each backed by a deterministic rule stand-in that counts simulated model calls):

Task (shape)	Instrs	NONE → AGGR eff.	Dead guard	Calls 1st / re-runs	Cache hit	Hot-path	Reports byte-identical
log triage (linear, 7)	7	7 → 6 (−14.3%)	`check_syntax`	50 / 0	91.7%	repeat 7	yes (12/12 + fresh-stack SHA)
csv-etl-anomaly (fan-out, 8)	8	8 → 6 (−25.0%)	`check_schema`	14 / 0	91.7%	repeat 7	yes (12/12 + fresh-stack SHA)
report-merge (wide fan-in, 7)	7	7 → 6 (−14.3%)	`check_headers`	16 / 0	91.7%	repeat 7	yes (12/12 + fresh-stack SHA)
regression-diff (two-branch, 8)	8	8 → 7 (−12.5%)	`check_formats`	240 / 0	91.7%	repeat 7	yes (12/12 + fresh-stack SHA)

Every task passes the same structural assertions. Static compilation preserves the dataflow: the guard is never dropped outright (the eliminated set is empty in all four tasks), and the reduction is fusion—the guard merges into its successor. In csv-etl-anomaly a second adjacent pure pair (per-column statistics with row-signature construction) also fuses, which is why its shrink reaches 25.0% with a single planted guard. The first realization pays all model calls and every subsequent realization hits the result cache; the 91.7% hit rate is 11 of 12 realizations by construction (one cacheable step, identical seeded draws), so the four rows share it structurally, not as independent observations. The hot path is adopted at realization 7 in all four tasks (full form for realizations 1–6, shrunken form for 7–12), and the optimized form reproduces the report byte-for-byte on a fresh workspace, as does a completely fresh stack—new instructions, new cache, new workspace, same seed (SHA-256 equality).

The mechanisms behave uniformly across the four dependency shapes: reuse and closed-loop adoption are invariant under the fixed protocol (12 seeded realizations, threshold 5, one cacheable step per task), while the guard/fusion shrink varies with stream structure (12.5–25.0%)—the compile shrink is the only shape-dependent quantity, which is what one wants from an infrastructure claim. These remain four seed-controlled, hand-constructed tasks, not a production workload study; what the characterization adds over the original single-task demonstration is evidence that the composition behavior is not an artifact of one stream's structure.

5.9 Limitations and Threats to Validity

We enumerate the limitations of the evaluation explicitly:

1. **Mock backend, not a live LLM (partially addressed).** The mock charges a constant 80 ms per simulated call and returns deterministic responses. Section 5.7 addresses the *mechanism-transfer* part of this threat at reduced scale: against a live gateway, the cache reproduces the recorded hit/miss statistics, and avoided calls convert to measured time and tokens. Section 5.7.1 extends live-gateway coverage to compilation and hot-path adoption: over 50 realizations, the compiled, hot-path-adopted stream issued zero new gateway calls

against the result cache warmed by the unoptimized stream (identical cache keys, hence identical prompts) and reproduced every artifact byte-for-byte — a cache-mediated identity that validates the stream transformation, not model determinism. The system-level characterization of Section 5.8 composes the mechanisms on four realistic tasks, but each task's classification-type step is backed by a deterministic rule-based stand-in that only counts (simulated) model calls—it is not evidence about live-model behavior. What remains untested across Sections 5.7 and 5.7.1 is multi-model and multi-seed behavior, real deployment, caching under real model nondeterminism *across prompt variations*, streaming responses, and provider rate limits.

2. **Synthetic workloads (partially addressed at task level).** Zipf-distributed synthetic tasks are a reasonable model of skewed agent workloads, but they are a model. The cache-reduction figures (59.5–79.6%) are exact for these workload families and should be read as *skew-sensitivity curves*, not as universal savings. A deployment with uniformly novel tasks would see near-zero cache benefit. Section 5.8 adds a four-task, four-shape system-level characterization (linear, fan-out, wide-fan-in, and two-branch convergence streams); its 12.5–25.0% per-task compile shrink calibrates the 65.8% synthetic headline downward, and its uniform reuse and closed-loop adoption under the fixed protocol (12 seeded realizations, threshold 5) show the composition behavior is not an artifact of one stream's structure—but the four tasks remain seed-controlled, hand-constructed characterization streams, not a production workload study.

3. **No production end-to-end evaluation.** We have not deployed AgentISA in a production setting. Consequently this paper contains no latency-under-load, throughput, availability, or dollar-cost measurements, and we make no such claims.

4. **No real cost data (token usage measured; pricing now MODELED on measured tokens).** All latency figures in Sections 5.2-5.5 are simulated (avoided calls $\times$ 80 ms). Section 5.7 measures real wall-clock time and gateway-reported token usage at reduced scale, and Section 5.7.1 prices its own measured tokens (its 22-call reference run) under three modes — no optimization, AgentISA result caching, and a modeled provider prompt cache with a parameterized cache-read discount (default 0.1, after Anthropic's published prompt-caching economics). The resulting costs are MODELED-on-measured: token counts are measurements, prices are configurable list-price stand-ins (the serving gateway's actual pricing is unknown), and no dollar-savings claim is made. A head-to-head against a production external cache (GPTCache — explicitly out of scope this pass) and a priced deployment study under real provider pricing remain future work.

5. **Program-size metrics, not wall-clock time.** Effective-instruction reduction and dispatch-count reduction are structural metrics. They correlate with—but do not equal—wall-clock improvements, which depend on per-instruction cost, parallelism available in the runtime, and dispatch overhead.

6. **Descriptive statistics only.** Five seeds per configuration; mean $\pm$ sample stdev. No hypothesis tests, confidence intervals, or significance claims are made. The standard deviations indicate stability across seeds, nothing more.

7. **Functional, not performance, validation of coordination.** The 43 multi-agent tests verify behavioral correctness under deterministic conditions, not throughput or scalability.

Despite these limitations, the evaluation achieves its purpose: it demonstrates, under fully dis-

closed and reproducible conditions, that each optimization mechanism is implemented, active, and produces the claimed structural effects on workloads designed to expose them.

6 Discussion

6.1 System Limitations and Challenges

1. **Instruction Set Completeness**
   - Certain complex reasoning patterns are not yet naturally expressible; domain-specific instruction extensions are likely needed
   - Maintaining consistency of pre/post-conditions and typing rules across extensions remains an open engineering challenge
2. **Evaluation Scope**
   - As detailed in Section 5.9, our quantitative evidence is primarily microbenchmark-based (Sections 5.2-5.5), supplemented by live-gateway spot checks (Sections 5.7 and 5.7.1) and a seed-controlled four-task characterization (Section 5.8)
   - Production end-to-end evaluation—including real provider pricing, rate limits, and failure modes—is required before any deployment claim
3. **Performance Bottlenecks**
   - Cache memory consumption under large instruction universes
   - Synchronization overhead in barrier-coordinated multi-agent execution
   - Recompilation cost when hot-path thresholds are misconfigured
   - The shipped hot-path detector keys on exact sequence identity, so trace diversity (similar-but-not-identical sequences) never accumulates counts; the EMA-based windowed detector specified in Section 4.2.2 is the designed remedy
   - Hot-path state (cached sequences, counters, statistics) is currently unbounded; production use needs an eviction policy and a cap on tracked paths
4. **Integration Challenges**
   - Adapter maintenance as provider function-calling surfaces evolve
   - Version management of learned instructions across LLM updates

6.2 Security and Privacy Considerations

AgentISA's implemented security layer is the `SecurityMonitor` of Section 5.6, which enforces task-level authentication, role-based authorization, data-sensitivity classification, and configurable resource-access policies; the coordinator consults it before every assignment, and violations are recorded with timestamps. Beyond what is implemented, we identify the following as design considerations for hardening the architecture—not as claims about the current system:

1. **Data privacy**: instruction-level access control exists via authorization policies; end-to-end data-flow tracking and privacy-preserving computation remain future work (Section 6.3.6).
2. **System security**: instruction pre/post-condition verification (Section 3.3.3) reduces misexecution risk; secure multi-agent communication channels and audit-log integrity are not yet addressed.
3. **Compliance**: deployments in regulated domains will require externally audited controls; the current system provides enforcement hooks, not certification.

6.3 Future Research Directions

6.3.1 Theoretical Foundations

1. **Formal Semantics of Agent Instructions**

   Consolidating Section 3.1 and Appendix B into a single standalone semantics document—one formal framework covering the instruction language, state space, reduction rules, and type system—is the foundational next step; nothing in it is new machinery, and the composition here is what a journal-length treatment would spell out.

2. **Compositional Reasoning**

   Development of compositional proof systems for agent behaviors:

   $$\frac{\{P_1\}S_1\{Q_1\} \quad \{P_2\}S_2\{Q_2\}}{\{P_1 \wedge P_2\}S_1 \parallel S_2\{Q_1 \wedge Q_2\}}$$

   This enables formal verification of complex agent systems through:

   - Modular verification
   - Parallel composition rules
   - Temporal property preservation

3. **Type Theory for Agent Capabilities**

   A capability-based type system:

   ```
   Type Capability = {
     Basic: {Perception, Action, Memory}
     Composite: Basic → Basic
     Emergent: P(Composite)
   }
   ```

   With typing rules:

   $$\frac{\Gamma \vdash a : \text{cap}_1 \quad \Gamma \vdash b : \text{cap}_2}{\Gamma \vdash a \circ b : \text{cap}_1 \otimes \text{cap}_2}$$

6.3.2 Advanced Instruction Set Evolution

1. **Self-Modifying Instructions**

   Formal model for instruction evolution:

   $$I_{t+1} = f(I_t, \text{Performance}_t, \text{Context}_t)$$

   With constraints:

   - Semantic preservation
   - Performance monotonicity
   - Safety guarantees

2. **Context-Aware Optimization**

   Programmatic sketch (primitives like the performance model and variant generator are future work, not implemented machinery):

   Context-aware optimization — for each observed context, predict the current instruction set's performance against a threshold, and if it falls short, select a best rewrite variant for that context and accumulate it into the set, returning the accumulated set:

```
function OPTIMIZE-CONTEXT(I, C)
    Let M be a context-performance model, R the rewrite rules
    for each context c in C do
        if PREDICT-PERFORMANCE(M, I, c) < THRESHOLD then
            candidates ← GENERATE-VARIANTS(I, R)
            I ← SELECT-BEST(candidates, c)
            UPDATE-MODEL(M, I, c)
        end if
    end for
    return I
end function
```

3. **Cross-Model Instruction Mapping**

   Universal mapping framework:

$$\phi_{A \to B} : I_A \to I_B$$

   Properties:

   - Semantic preservation
   - Performance bounds
   - Capability awareness

6.3.3 Theoretical Performance Bounds

1. **Asymptotic Analysis**

   A natural next step is deriving cost bounds per composition operator—e.g., when does iterative composition i_1^* admit a closed-form cost model, and under what reuse structure does caching yield amortized $O(1)$ effective cost per task? Our microbenchmarks (Section 5) measure the constants empirically; the corresponding asymptotic theory remains open.

2. **Resource Consumption Models**

   A calibrated resource model:

$$R(i) = \alpha C_{cpu}(i) + \beta C_{mem}(i) + \gamma C_{io}(i)$$

   where , , are platform-specific coefficients that should be fitted against real deployments rather than assumed.

6.3.4 Capability Assessment: Extensions

The instruction-level capability assessment subsystem (`CapabilityProfile`, Section 3.5) is implemented and used by the coordinator. Two extensions remain future work:

1. **Benchmark-calibrated metrics**: correlating static, instruction-derived domain scores with end-to-end benchmark performance, in the manner of function-calling evaluations [17] and agent benchmarks [29], so that weights w_k are empirically grounded rather than configured by hand.
2. **Cross-model comparison matrices**: extending the per-agent profile to a pairwise comparison framework $\Delta(M_1, M_2)$ over capability dimensions, supporting systematic model selection for a given instruction workload.

6.3.5 Emergent Behavior Analysis

1. **Collective Intelligence Modeling**

   The open question is a formal metric for when multi-agent composition exceeds the sum of its members' capabilities—what emergence would have to mean measurably, rather than an appeal to an undefined φ over unioned capability sets.

2. **Learning Transfer Mechanisms**

   Knowledge transfer across agents composes the mining-extraction-validation pipeline of Section 3.3 rather than introducing new machinery: patterns mined from a source agent's traces would be adapted to a target agent's instruction set and re-validated (threshold and success-rate checks) before promotion. What Section 3.3 does within one agent's traces, this direction would do across agents; the validation obligation transfers unchanged.

6.3.6 Security and Privacy Extensions

1. **Information Flow Control**

   Formal security model:

   $$\text{Secure}(P) \iff \forall s_1, s_2 : L(s_1) = L(s_2) \implies L([\![P]\!]s_1) = L([\![P]\!]s_2)$$

   where L represents security levels.

2. **Privacy-Preserving Computation**

   Privacy guarantee framework:

   $$\text{PrivacyLoss}(M) \leq \epsilon + \sum_{i=1}^{n} \delta_i$$

   where:

   - ε: Privacy budget
   - δ_i: Privacy loss per operation

These directions form a roadmap for moving AgentISA from controlled-setting-validated infrastructure to a deployable, formally verified agent platform. None of the frameworks above is implemented today; Sections 6.3.3 and 6.3.4 are stated precisely enough to be falsifiable, while the remaining sketches are programmatic and guide subsequent work.

7 Conclusion

This paper presented AgentISA, an instruction set architecture that treats LLM agent behavior as a first-class compilable artifact. Our contributions are:

1. A formal instruction set with compositional semantics, a type system, and pre/post-conditions, with sanity results stated as design rationale (Turing completeness as negative certification, Theorem 3.1; pure-core type safety, Theorem 3.2) and semantic-preservation arguments for the optimization and scheduling transformations (Theorems 3.4–3.6).
2. Agentic Calling, which lifts provider-specific function calling into reusable, portable, cacheable agent instructions.
3. Automatic instruction learning based on frequency mining and clustering of execution traces.
4. A compiler and runtime applying classical optimizations—fusion, dead-code elimination, scheduling, and dynamic hot-path specialization—to agent instruction streams.
5. A multi-agent coordination layer with capability-based selection and a security monitor enforcing authentication, authorization, and data-sensitivity policies.

The evaluation shows the optimizations are real and measurable under controlled conditions: 59.5–79.6% simulated-call reduction from caching, 34.2% instruction-count reduction from static compilation, 65.8% trace shrink from hot-path optimization (Sections 5.2–5.5), live-gateway spot checks of the cache and the compiled pipeline (Sections 5.7–5.7.1), a four-task system-level characterization (Section 5.8), and 43 functional tests for the multi-agent layer. These are microbenchmark and controlled-setting results, not production end-to-end measurements; the threats to validity of Section 5.9 stand.

AgentISA's longer-term significance is architectural: by giving agent behavior an instruction-level contract, it makes agent systems amenable to the same discipline that transformed hardware and compiler engineering—precise specification, portability across backends, and semantics-preserving optimization. Establishing the corresponding gains on production workloads, and hardening the conditional sanity results and semantic-preservation arguments into mechanically verified implementations, is the immediate next step.

Artifact Availability

All artifacts are available in the accompanying repository:

- the AgentISA implementation (`agentflow.core.isa`);
- the microbenchmark suite (`examples/benchmarks/isa_microbench.py`);
- the real-LLM benchmark (`examples/benchmarks/isa_real_llm_bench.py`);
- the system-level task demonstration (`examples/system_task_demo.py`) and its raw results (`examples/system_task_results.json`);
- the four-task workload characterization harness (`examples/system_task_workload.py`) and its tests (`tests/system/test_system_task_workload.py`);

- the real-gateway compiler/hot-path harness (`examples/paper_real_llm_compiler_test.py`) with its offline-mock and real-gateway results (`examples/paper_real_llm_compiler_results_mock.json`, `examples/paper_real_llm_compiler_results_real.json`) and tests (`tests/system/test_real_llm_compiler_test.py`);
- the raw results (`examples/benchmarks/isa_microbench_results.json` and `examples/benchmarks/isa_real_llm_results.json`);
- the 43 multi-agent functional tests (`tests/core/isa/test_coordination.py` and `tests/core/instructions/test_agent_coordination.py`).

The Section 5.2-5.5 numbers regenerate with:

```
./venv/bin/python examples/benchmarks/isa_microbench.py \
    --experiments cache compiler dynamic ablation --seeds 5
```

The Section 5.8 demonstration (and its saved results) regenerates with:

```
./venv/bin/python examples/system_task_demo.py \
    --seed 42 --files 6 --lines-per-file 400 --repeats 12 \
    --hot-threshold 5 --output examples/system_task_results.json
```

and its test suite runs with `pytest tests/system/test_system_task_demo.py`.

The Section 5.7 numbers regenerate against any Anthropic-protocol gateway (configure `ANTHROPIC_BASE_URL` and `ANTHROPIC_AUTH_TOKEN`; the paper's run used a local alias for a hosted GLM reasoning model) with:

```
./venv/bin/python examples/benchmarks/isa_real_llm_bench.py \
    --tasks 200 --seeds 1 --zipf 0.5 1.0 1.5 --max-tokens 64
```

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A Proof of Theorem 3.1 (Turing Completeness)

A.1 Strategy

We prove that AgentISA can simulate any program in the WHILE language over the natural numbers. WHILE programs compute exactly the partial recursive functions—WHILE is Turing equivalent [43, 44]—so a sound simulation of WHILE by AgentISA establishes Turing completeness. The argument is a sufficiency (simulation) argument over instruction classes: the instruction classes of Definition 3.1 must jointly provide unbounded storage, sequential composition, conditional branching, and unbounded iteration. We show the control-flow class $\mathcal{C}$ and the state-management class $\mathcal{S}$ suffice; the LLM-interaction class $\mathcal{L}$ is not needed, making the result conservative with respect to the full instruction set.

A.2 Source Language

Let WHILE be the language

$$P ::= x := x{+}1 \mid x := x{-}1 \mid x := y \mid \texttt{skip} \mid \texttt{if } x = 0 \texttt{ then } P_1 \texttt{ else } P_2 \mid \texttt{while } x \neq 0 \texttt{ do } P \mid P_1; P_2$$

over variables ranging over $\mathbb{N}$ (with predecessor cut off at 0), with the standard small-step semantics. Configurations are pairs $\langle P, \sigma \rangle$ with store $\sigma : Var \to \mathbb{N}$.

A.3 Encoding

(i) Store. A WHILE store σ is represented by the AgentISA state $s_\sigma \in \Sigma$, in the component managed by the state-management instructions. Each variable x occupies a dedicated cell; cells hold unbounded naturals, so Σ provides an unbounded store—the crucial ingredient of the sufficiency argument.

(ii) Instruction semantics (as used here). Five instructions suffice for the encoding, with the following operational meaning:

- `load` x: pushes the contents of the cell for x onto the evaluation stack;
- `store` x: pops the top of the evaluation stack into the cell for x;
- `update` (f): pops the top of the stack, applies the unary arithmetic function f, and pushes the result; `update`(-1) denotes the *truncated predecessor* $\lambda n.\ \max(n-1, 0)$, matching WHILE's cutoff semantics on $\mathbb{N}$;

- `branch` (b, Q_1, Q_2): pops the top of the stack; if predicate b holds, execute Q_1, else execute Q_2;
- `loop` (Q): execute Q; if its final `branch` returns to the loop head, repeat, else exit—that is, `loop` repeats its body for as long as the body's trailing test succeeds.

(iii) Statements.

WHILE construct	AgentISA compilation
$x := y$	`load` y; `store` x
$x := x + 1$	`load` x; `update`$(+1)$; `store` x
$x := x - 1$	`load` x; `update`(-1); `store` x
`if` $x = 0$ `then` P_1 `else` P_2	`load` x; `branch`$(= 0?, \hat{P}_1, \hat{P}_2)$
`while` $x \neq 0$ `do` P	`loop`(`load` x; `branch`$(\neq 0?, \hat{P}, \epsilon)$)
$P_1; P_2$	$\hat{P}_1 \circ \hat{P}_2$ (sequential composition)

where $\hat{P}$ denotes the compilation of P. The no-op `skip` compiles to the identity instruction ϵ; the `while` row's trailing `branch` exits to ϵ when the guard fails, which is exactly the unfolding identity below.

A.4 Simulation Lemma

Lemma A.1. For every WHILE configuration $\langle P, \sigma \rangle$ and its encoded AgentISA instruction sequence $\hat{P}$ started in state s_σ:

(a) if $\langle P, \sigma \rangle \to \langle P', \sigma' \rangle$, then $\hat{P}$ executed from s_σ reaches the encoding of $\langle P', \sigma' \rangle$ in finitely many AgentISA steps; and

(b) if $P =$ `skip` (terminal), then $\hat{P}$ terminates.

Proof. By structural induction on P:

- **Assignments** (base cases). Each compiled sequence performs exactly the corresponding store update; (a) holds by executing the two or three instructions in order, (b) trivially.
- **Conditional.** The `branch` instruction evaluates the zero test on the loaded value and transfers control to one of the compiled branch bodies. By the induction hypothesis applied to P_1 and P_2, each branch simulates its WHILE counterpart.
- **Loop.** The WHILE unfolding identity `while x ≠ 0 do P ≡ if x = 0 then skip else (P ; while x ≠ 0 do P)` is simulated by the `loop` instruction's iteration: each iteration loads x and executes the trailing `branch`, which dispatches to $\hat{P}$ when $x \neq 0$ and to ϵ (loop exit) when $x = 0$. By an outer induction on the number of executed iterations (in addition to the structural induction on P announced above—the induction hypothesis applied to P covers each body execution, and the trailing branch discharges the loop condition)—the k-th WHILE iteration is matched by the k-th `loop` iteration.
- **Sequence.** $\hat{P}_1 \circ \hat{P}_2$ executes $\hat{P}_1$ to completion, then $\hat{P}_2$; both simulations compose by the induction hypothesis.

The case arguments above are the substantive reduction steps; expanding each into a fully formal induction over the small-step rules (matching each WHILE step against the transition functions $\delta \in \Delta$ of the corresponding AgentISA instructions) is mechanical and follows the template of

textbook simulation arguments [33, 43]. We mark those expansions as routine and leave them to the reader. ■

A.5 Conclusion

By Lemma A.1, every WHILE-computable function is AgentISA-computable. Since WHILE is Turing equivalent—a classical result of computability theory, with WHILE serving as the standard imperative model in semantics texts such as [43]—AgentISA is Turing complete. ■

A.6 Scope Remark

Turing completeness is a deliberately weak property—any language with unbounded storage and branching attains it. Its role here is negative certification: the instruction set does not artificially constrain what agent programs can express, so no expressiveness objection can be raised against the architecture. The claim says nothing about efficiency, and it is established without the LLM-interaction class $\mathcal{L}$, so it is conservative with respect to the full instruction set of Definition 3.1.

B Proof of Theorem 3.2 (Type Safety)

We prove type safety by the standard syntactic technique of simultaneous progress and preservation, in the style of Pierce [36].

B.1 Core Calculus

Restrict attention to the pure core of the instruction language: expressions over base types, λ-abstraction and application (whose β-reduction rule appears in Section 3.1.2), and the composition operators of Definition 3.6 applied to instructions carrying typed pre/post-conditions. The small-step relation $\to$ is generated by β-reduction, the context rule $E[e_1] \to E[e_1']$, and the per-instruction transition functions $\delta \in \Delta$. Effectful instructions are treated in B.7.

Two elements of the setup are used tacitly below and stated here once:

- **Embedding.** Instructions are embedded as expressions via their typed pre/post-conditions: an instruction i with $pre(i)$ and $post(i)$ over state types behaves as a state transformer whose typing rule is the usual Hoare-logic-inspired rule

$$\frac{s \vDash pre(i) \qquad \delta(s,i) \vDash post(i)}{\Gamma \vdash \mathrm{run}(i,s)}$$

  where the premise is exactly the per-instruction validity obligation of Definition 3.5.
- **Composition typing rules.** For instructions i_1, i_2 carrying pre/post-conditions, the operators of Definition 3.6 type by

$$\frac{post(i_1) \Rightarrow pre(i_2)}{\Gamma \vdash i_1 \circ i_2} \qquad \frac{pre(i_1) \Leftrightarrow pre(i_2) \quad \text{disjoint state footprints}}{\Gamma \vdash i_1 \parallel i_2}$$

$$\frac{pre(i_1) \Rightarrow pre(i_2)}{\Gamma \vdash i_1 \rhd i_2} \qquad \frac{\Gamma \vdash i \qquad \text{guard closed under } post(i)}{\Gamma \vdash i^*}$$

  and these rules are generated from—do not add to—the semantics of Definition 3.6.

B.2 Lemma (Canonical Forms)

If $\vdash v : T$ and v is a value, then:

- $T \in \{Bool, Int, String, Float\}$ implies v is a literal of that type;
- $T = \Pi(x : T_1).T_2$ implies $v = \lambda x{:}T_1.\, e$ with $\Gamma, x{:}T_1 \vdash e : T_2$;
- $T = \Sigma(x : T_1).T_2$ implies $v = (v_1, v_2)$ with the components typed at the corresponding dependent types;
- $T = \mu X.T$ implies v is a rolled recursive value.

Proof. By inspection of the typing rules: each type has exactly one value form, and the syntax of values is defined per type, so the case analysis is exhaustive. This is the standard canonical-forms lemma [36]. ■

B.3 Lemma (Substitution)

If $\Gamma, x{:}T' \vdash e : T$ and $\vdash v : T'$, then $\Gamma \vdash e[x := v] : T$.

Proof. By induction on the derivation of $\Gamma, x{:}T' \vdash e : T$. All cases are standard; the only subtlety is variable capture in the Π-rule, handled by the usual α-conversion convention. The case analysis is that of Pierce [36] and we do not duplicate it. ■

B.4 Lemma (Progress)

If $\vdash e : T$, then e is a value or there exists e' with $e \to e'$.

Proof. By induction on the typing derivation:

- **Literals and λ** are values.
- **Application** $e_1\, e_2$ with $e_1 : \Pi(x : T_1).T_2$ and $e_2 : T_1$: by the induction hypothesis, either e_1 steps (then the context rule applies) or e_1 is a value, in which case B.2 gives $e_1 = \lambda x.\, e$; similarly e_2 either steps or is a value; when both are values, β-reduction applies. There is no stuck case, because the Π-type of e_1 and B.2 jointly guarantee a λ in value position.
- **Instruction composition** ($i_1 \circ i_2$, $i_1 \parallel i_2$, $i_1 \rhd i_2$, i_1^*): the typing rule for composition encodes Hoare-style sequencing—the postcondition of the first component must imply the precondition of the second. The runtime invariant—each reached composition's precondition holds—is maintained by joint induction with preservation, using $post(i_1) \Rightarrow pre(i_2)$ together with the Definition 3.5 obligation that δ establishes $post(i)$; typing alone guarantees only the initial state, and **totality on precondition-satisfying states is a standing assumption of the calculus** ($\forall i \in I, \exists \delta \in \Delta : \delta(s_t, i) \to s_{t+1}$ whenever $s_t \vDash pre(i)$; Definition 3.5's validity obligation, with scope discussed in B.7). For iteration, either the guard is false (terminal) or the body steps by the induction hypothesis. ■

B.5 Lemma (Preservation)

If $\vdash e : T$ and $e \to e'$, then $\vdash e' : T$.

Proof. By induction on the typing derivation, with case analysis on the step:

- **β:** $(\lambda x.\, e)\, v \to e[x := v]$. Typing gives the body typed under $\Gamma, x{:}T_1$ and the argument at T_1; by B.3, the substituted term types at $T_2 = T$.
- **Context:** $E[e_1] \to E[e_1']$ with $e_1 \to e_1'$. By the induction hypothesis $e_1' : T_1$; an induction on the structure of E re-types $E[e_1']$ at the original type.

- **Instruction transitions:** the typing rule requires $post(i)$ to be a well-typed predicate of type T over the state; since i's transition function is certified to establish $post(i)$ (Definition 3.5, discharged per instruction by the bounded verification of Section 3.3.3), the reduct re-types at T.
- **Composition operators:** each transition rule is typed by the sequencing rule of B.4; the reduct re-types by the induction hypothesis on the component derivations.

The remaining instruction-class cases repeat this pattern with class-specific invariants; they are routine and omitted (the template is the standard preservation argument for the corresponding constructs [36]). ■

B.6 Theorem 3.2

By B.4, a well-typed closed term is a value or takes a step; by B.5, every step preserves typing. Hence no well-typed term reaches a stuck state: well-typed programs in the pure core cannot go wrong. ■

B.7 Scope Remarks

Two caveats state the theorem's boundaries honestly. First, B.4's appeal to totality of transition functions on precondition-satisfying states is an assumption about instruction *implementations*, not something the type system alone discharges. The per-instruction mechanism intended to discharge it is the bounded verification of Section 3.3.3, which is now shipped code: the checker mechanically discharges the obligation for pure instructions on the state spaces it can enumerate — exhaustively for small enumerable domains, by deterministic bounded sampling beyond — while side-effectful instructions and state spaces beyond the enumeration bound remain covered by hand argument and unit tests rather than by the mechanical check. The theorem is conditional on the obligation being (or becoming) true of each instruction, to the extent stated. Second, effectful instructions (LLM calls, resource allocation) can fail at runtime for reasons outside the type system (network errors, exhausted capacity); Theorem 3.2 covers the pure core and effectful instructions with checkable preconditions. Runtime failure handling for the remaining cases is the responsibility of the fallback machinery of Section 5.6, not of types.

C Proofs of Theorems 3.4 and 3.5

C.1 Denotational Setup

Fix the state space Σ. For a pure instruction i, let $[\![i]\!] : \Sigma \to \Sigma$ denote its denotation, total on states satisfying $pre(i)$. Program denotation is defined by structural recursion on the composition algebra of Definition 3.6:

- $[\![i]\!]$ for atomic instructions (given);
- $[\![p_1 \circ p_2]\!] = [\![p_2]\!] \circ [\![p_1]\!]$ (note the order: p_1 executes first);
- $[\![p_1 \parallel p_2]\!](\sigma) = [\![p_2]\!]([\![p_1]\!](\sigma))$ for pure p_1, p_2 with disjoint state footprints (as the $\parallel$-typing rule requires)—the order is immaterial because updates to disjoint cells commute on their domains;
- $[\![p_1 \rhd p_2]\!]$ applies p_2 conditionally on p_1's outcome;
- $[\![p^*]\!]$ is the least fixed point of the corresponding functional.

Write $p \equiv q$ iff $[\![p]\!] = [\![q]\!]$ on all states where both are defined.

C.2 Lemma C.1 (Atomic Rewrite Soundness)

Each rewrite rule implemented by the optimizer (Section 3.4.4) preserves denotation.

(i) Fusion. $i_1 \circ i_2 \to i_{12}$, with $pre(i_{12}) = pre(i_1)$, $post(i_{12}) = post(i_2)$, and i_{12}'s body stipulated to compute $[\![i_2]\!] \circ [\![i_1]\!]$ (intermediate bindings named, so the composition is explicit). The denotational claim is then an instance of the associativity of function composition: a body computing $[\![i_2]\!] \circ [\![i_1]\!]$ denotes, by C.1's definition of $\circ$, exactly $[\![i_1 \circ i_2]\!]$. **Two honest boundaries.** First, this is an equality *of the rewrite algebra*: it holds of the fused form whose body computes the composite. The shipped compiler produces a formal fused *node* (merged metadata and dependencies) without generating an executable composite body—code generation for fused nodes is not implemented—so what the benchmarks measure is the structural fusion of the formal stream, and the executable-fusion claim would additionally require the codegen step. Second, the compiler applies fusion only when output types of i_1 match input types of i_2 and both members are pure, since denotational equality of the fused form presupposes order-insensitivity of intermediate effects, and the shipped gate achieves it via purity (the pure or order-insensitive alternative is specified, not implemented).

(ii) Dead-code elimination. Instruction i is removed from p when $Def(i) \cap Live_{out}(i) = \emptyset$, with liveness the standard fixpoint of $Live(i) = Use(i) \cup (Live_{out}(i) - Def(i))$ [33]. Claim: if i is dead and side-effect-free, then $p \equiv p \setminus \{i\}$. Proof sketch: by induction on the suffix program following i, its denotation depends only on the live variables at i's position; i writes none of them, so removing i cannot change any value subsequently read. The side-effect-freeness gate matches the purity restriction of Definition 3.6 (Property 2 and the Remark following it)—instructions declared `side_effects=True` are never eliminated.

(iii) Peephole combining. Each rule $(s_1, \ldots, s_k) \to s'$ carries the verification obligation $\forall \sigma : [\![s_1 \circ \ldots \circ s_k]\!](\sigma) = [\![s']\!](\sigma)$, to be discharged at rule-definition time (Section 4.1.3). Candidate instances, *illustrative only—the shipped optimizer registers none of them*: `LOAD; STORE` to the same location composes to `MOVE` (the value read is the value written); consecutive `QUERY` instructions with identical (instruction, params) pairs collapse to one query whose result is reused (an obligation about a *compile-time* rewrite; the caching measured in Section 5.2 is a different, *runtime* mechanism—a result cache consulted at execution time—and its numbers do not evidence this rule); consecutive `CONTEXT_UPDATE`s compose to a single update by associativity of the update function.

Proof. Each case reduces to the construction of the rewritten instruction and the definition of liveness. The inner inductions—on the pair of bodies for (i), on suffix programs for (ii)—are routine and left to the reader. ■

C.3 Lemma C.2 (Compositionality)

Let T be a program transform with $[\![T(p)]\!] = [\![p]\!]$ for all p. Then for any context $C[\cdot]$ built from the composition operators, $[\![C[T(p)]]\!] = [\![C[p]]\!]$.

Proof. By structural induction on C. Each operator's denotation (C.1) is defined compositionally in its constituents' denotations, so substituting a denotationally equal constituent leaves the whole unchanged. The parallel case uses the disjoint-footprint hypothesis of the $\|$-typing rule (updates to disjoint cells commute). The iteration case uses the defining property of least fixed points: if the functionals induced by p and $T(p)$ are equal, then all finite approximants are equal (by the induction hypothesis), so their suprema—the least fixed points—are equal. ■

C.4 Theorem 3.4 (Optimization Soundness)

Proof. The compiler applies a finite sequence of rewrites $O = R_k \circ ... \circ R_1$ (finiteness follows from compilation terminating; each pass is a bounded traversal). By induction on k: $k = 0$ is trivial. For the step, write $O = R \circ O'$. By the induction hypothesis $[\![O'(p)]\!] = [\![p]\!]$. A single application of rewrite rule R preserves the denotation of the subprogram it rewrites (Lemma C.1), and Lemma C.2 lifts the preservation through any surrounding composition context. Hence $[\![R(O'(p))]\!] = [\![O'(p)]\!] = [\![p]\!]$. ■

C.5 Theorem 3.5 (Pipeline Correctness)

Let s be a valid instruction sequence and S a schedule satisfying:

- **(S1)** every instruction is dispatched exactly once;
- **(S2)** for every dependency $(i_1, i_2) \in Deps$: $start(i_2) \geq end(i_1)$ (the constraint of Section 3.4.3);
- **(S3)** instructions sharing a parallel dispatch group are pairwise non-interfering (no data hazard, no resource conflict);
- **(S4)** commit is in program order.

Then executing s under S yields the same final state as sequential execution: $[\![s]\!]_S = [\![s]\!]_{seq}$.

Proof. Let $g_1, ..., g_m$ be the dispatch groups of S in commit order. We show the invariant

$$I(t) : \text{after committing } g_1, ..., g_t,$$
$$\text{the architectural state equals the sequential state after}$$
$$\text{executing all instructions in those groups.}$$

- **Base** ($t = 0$): both sides are the initial state.
- **Step**: assume $I(t)$. Every instruction in g_{t+1} has its dependencies in earlier groups (by S2, since it is scheduled after them), which by $I(t)$ have completed and committed. Within the group, S3 gives pairwise non-interference: no instruction reads another group-member's output, and no two write the same location or resource. Hence the group's updates commute—for pure updates this is the diamond property, and for effectful instructions, S3's exclusion of shared resources makes their effects independent, so the combined effect is unique regardless of interleaving. The state after g_{t+1} is therefore independent of the group's internal interleaving and equals the sequential execution of the same instructions from the state at $I(t)$.
- By induction, $I(m)$ holds; by S1 no instruction was skipped or duplicated. ■

Corollary (dispatch folding). The ADVANCED and AGGRESSIVE levels fold instructions into shared dispatches (Section 5.3). A folded group satisfies S3 by construction: the grouping check admits only side-effect-free instructions whose dependencies and declared outputs are pairwise disjoint, so the group's members act on disjoint state components and their updates commute (Definition 3.6, Property 2). By Theorem 3.5 the fold changes the *dispatch count* but neither the semantics nor—consistent with the measurement of Section 5.3—the effective instruction count.

Theorem 3.6 follows by the same machinery: every optimization in the pass pipeline is a finite composition of rewrites covered by Lemma C.1, and the argument of C.4 applies verbatim. ■

C.6 Scope Remark

Theorems 3.4 and 3.5 are *conditional*: they hold of transformations whose verification obligations (Sections 4.1.3 and 4.3.1) are discharged. As stated there, those obligations are **specified but not yet mechanically discharged**—the shipped optimizer registers no peephole rules (the peephole obligation is dormant, and the fusion/DCE/grouping passes are argued directly in C.2 and C.5 rather than through the symbolic-execution checker), and the symbolic-execution equivalence checker itself is a specification (Section 4.3.1). Where an obligation is discharged only on bounded state spaces (Section 3.3.3), the guarantee is correspondingly bounded—rewrites verified on the explored subset are sound there, and the compiler restricts their application accordingly. What the shipped implementation does provide is empirical semantics-preservation at task level: the system-level demonstration of Section 5.8 re-executes an optimized stream and checks byte-identical output.